



Level

1

Van der Wal course

KNDB Courses:

1. Van der Wal

Workbook

2. Wiersma

Workbook

3. Sijbrands

Workbook

4. Roozenburg

Workbook

5. Springer

Workbook

6. Hoogland

Workbook

In this course:

-  Basic rules and tactics for starting players
-  Capturing pieces and movement with a king
-  Attacking weak pieces
-  And much more!

This course is suited for new players!

Composed by:
Bert Dollekamp

2001

Annex
workbook, composed by:
Gert Dankers

Content

This course consists of three themes. Each theme consists of four lessons, which will take about an hour to complete. Each theme has its own page numbering. So, theme 1 will start off with page number 1.1, theme 2 with 2.1, and theme 3 with page number 3.1.

Answers to the exercises you will find after theme 3. Again, this part has its own page numbering.

After the answers, you will find two exercise books. In this part, you're able to practice your skills.

Again, the exercise books have their own page numbering.

Theme 1 Draughts

Lesson 1	Draughts	1.2
Lesson 2	Capturing and the majority rule	1.7
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Lesson 4	Think, then move	1.14

Theme 2 Making plans

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Theme 3 Playing better draughts

Lesson 9	Developing	3.2
Lesson 10	The endgame	3.6
Lesson 11	All kinds of shots	3.10
Lesson 12	Good game!	3.14

At the end of this course answers to exercises of the first three themes

Jannes van der Wal

September 1996, the whole draughts population is in shock, as it learns that Jannes van der Wal suddenly passed away after a short, but very serious illness. A year later, publisher *Profiel* publishes a book full of stories and anecdotes, called *Jannes*. His first name is sufficient: Jannes had been a celebrity in the Netherlands for years. His diligence and boldness (off and at the board) might already have its roots in a childhood event. This story is told to us by his one-year-older brother Harke.

“Jannes was a little explorer, but also quite naughty. Like no one he tortured mum and dad with his stubbornness. The rules they set where not only to be explored, but also to be broken. I always took their warnings very serious, but Jannes seemed to totally neglect them. My parents tried every trick in the book, but no form of punishment was able to keep Jannes in line.”

“My mum wasn’t really surprised when an angry bus driver called by our house with Jannes in his hands while a bus full of passengers was waiting down the street: for the umpteenth time he had to come to a full stop because that little brat was walking up the street without looking either right or left. The bus driver asked whether this boy might live here, and whether his parents weren’t able to do something about this...”

Passion

Jannes van der Wal was born November 12th, 1956, in a small Frisian village. His passion for draughts already started in elementary school. In middle and high school, he succeeds only barely to temper his enthusiasm. For example, he once turned in a draughts composition as a report. Nevertheless he graduated high school with honors. In the meantime, at the age of 18, he became national youth champion, which started off his turbulent career.

From 1977 on, Jannes participated in the Dutch championship for 16 consecutive years. Four times he took the title home, but even when he didn’t succeed in that, he always managed to get the newspapers talking. In the 1986 championship in Utrecht, for example, he lost a game by forfeit. Jannes had had a rough night in his home town Groningen before the game, and decided to get some rest on the train, only to wake up when the train was already on its way back.

Jokes

This incident led to a lot of jokes. Jannes didn’t mind at all, he loved being the odd one out. He once told a journalist: “I’ve never minded that people laughed at Jannes van der Wal, or thought he was crazy. When someone makes a joke on the king, people will start to question whether that’s polite. Jannes van der Wal can be made fun of by everyone. That’s just my part in society.”

World champion

In 1982 Jannes van der Wal wins the world championship in Sao Paulo. It's the major highlight of his career and a true reward for his daunting playing style. Jannes wants to win each and every game, and he sure plays like that. Sometimes he doesn't really have enough time left on the clock to do that, but even in severe time trouble he manages to bluff his opponents. It's no surprise he won the Dutch championship in blitz draughts four times. Jannes van der Wal became the big name in every tournament and studied the game very intensively. He loves to play unintelligible types of play. The draw margin keeps bugging him. Also, he starts to get the feeling he's seen everything in draughts. In 1983, he told an interviewer: "Draughts actually is painful for me ever since I became a professional player at the age of 19. I always want to come up with new things. But continuously you'll have to share your secrets and come up with something

new. Sometimes I've come up with a wonderful move, a great new find. That gets scrutinized over and over and I have to think of something new. I don't see a lot of possibilities to keep up to that level."

Chess

In the nineties Jannes turns his back on the world of draughts. He passionately starts playing both bridge and chess. He especially focuses on chess and becomes a FIDE master. He also wins the Dutch championship in the "mind marathon": a tournament which includes games in draughts, chess and bridge. In 1996 he spends his last moments in the spotlights. In the Dutch city Stadskanaal he plays a simultaneous exhibition against almost 100 opponents, mixing chess and draughts. He proceeds to score 93% of the possible points. This still is a world record, and has a rightful place in the famous *Guinness Book of Records*.

Nikhila (translated by Martijn van der Klis)

Before you start...

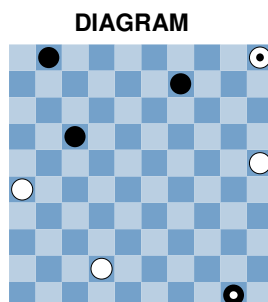
Next to this text you'll see a picture of draughts board. We'll call that a diagram. You'll see a lot of them in the coming course. A diagram can have the following characters:

 = a white piece

 = a black piece

 = a white king

 = a black king



The diagrams might also have arrows. These mark moves that have been played. In the exercises, we ask you to draw arrows to point out the correct move. It's a good idea to use a pencil for that. If you would then make a mistake by accident, you can easily erase it.

The player who plays the white pieces we call *white*.

The player who plays the black pieces we call *black*.

In almost all diagrams, white plays upwards, and black plays downwards. And usually, it's white's turn. If it black's turn, of course we'll tell you in advance.

You will also find these signs:



This introduces a rule of play.



This introduces an important piece of advice.



This introduces an exercise.

Good luck, and foremost: have fun!

Draughts

Theme

1

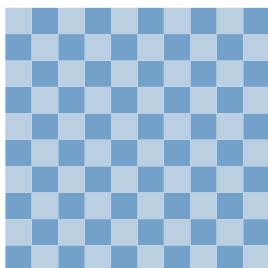
What's in this theme?

Lesson 1	Draughts	1.2
Lesson 2	Capturing and the majority rule	1.7
Lesson 3	King!	1.11
Lesson 4	Think, then move	1.15

Lesson 1

Draughts

DIAGRAM 1



Almost everybody is familiar with the game of draughts, although almost no-one is aware of the exact rules of play. This first lesson will make you aware of the most important rules. If you don't yet know them, you're able to learn them easily. If you do know how to play, check if you play the game according to the right rules!

Let's get the board and pieces out, we're going to play draughts!

Board and pieces

The board on which draughts is played has 50 light and 50 dark squares. We'll call this "fields". In DIAGRAM 1, the draughts board is in the correct position. Keep the following in mind:



The bottom left field should be a dark one.

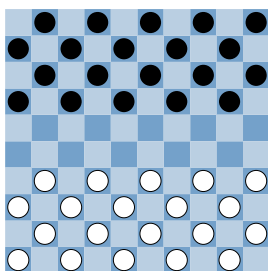
You can now put the pieces on the board, if you hadn't already done so... Twenty white pieces, and an equal amount for black. All pieces should be on dark squares. Does the position on your board align with DIAGRAM 2? Then you're doing it right! This is the initial position for a game of draughts. Let's play!

White and black take their turns one by one. And...



White gets to play first.

DIAGRAM 2



Moving pieces

Pieces are moved in this manner:

- ✓ diagonally
- ✓ one field at a time
- ✓ you can't move backwards!

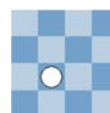
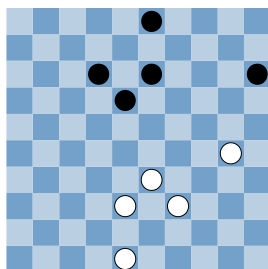


DIAGRAM 3



Exercise 1

Put in the correct numbers

In DIAGRAM 3, it's white's turn. We might abbreviate that into: "white to play". He can choose from..... moves. After that, white can choose from..... moves.

In the initial position, displayed in DIAGRAM 2, white has..... possible moves. After that, black can choose from moves.

Answers to these exercises you can find after the third theme. But of course, you should try to find the answers yourself first!

Jannes gives a lesson in draughts

How to make a move in draughts, that should be clear to everyone.

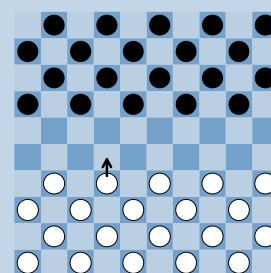
Although...

The Commissioner of the Dutch Queen in Drenthe (a northern province in the Netherlands), once had to lead off the Dutch Championship. The diagram on the left shows which move she played at Jannes van der

Wal's board. It was then she got her first draughts lesson from Jannes:

"I'm sorry madam, but this move isn't allowed. In draughts, one can only move diagonally!"

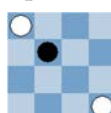
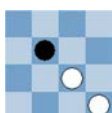
DIAGRAM 4



Capturing

Capturing pieces is done like this:

White is able to make a capture... He moves his piece up and jumps over the black piece...



And he takes the piece he jumped over from the board.

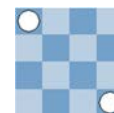
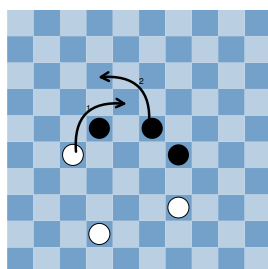


DIAGRAM 5



In DIAGRAM 5, it's white to play. He's able to capture a piece.

Enact this capture on your own board. Don't forget to take the captured piece off the board.

Now it's black's turn. He can also make a capture. This time backwards, not forwards! One of the rules of draughts is:

 *You can capture both forwards and backwards.*

It's very well possible that you miss an opportunity to capture. And sometimes you might notice that you can, though you'd rather make another move. However: the simple rule is, and this one of the most important rules in draughts:

 *Capturing is obligatory.*

If you're able to make a capture, you will have to make this move. When you fail to make a capture, you should be notified by your opponent. And of course, when you see your opponent should make a capture, but he misses the opportunity, you should notify him as well.



Exercise 2

Below you will find three positions. It's white's turn in all of them. Try to see whether he has an opportunity to make a capture. If he can, mark this capture with an arrow, just like the example in diagram 5.

DIAGRAM 6

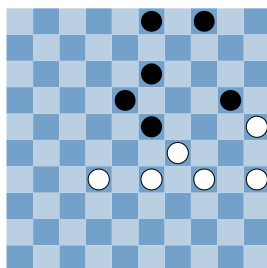


DIAGRAM 7

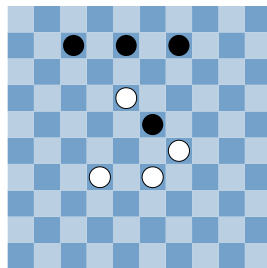


DIAGRAM 8

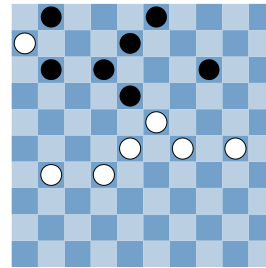
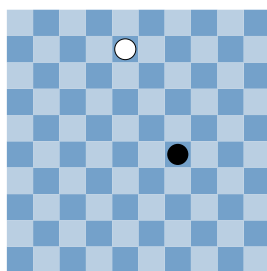


DIAGRAM 9



The king

In DIAGRAM 9, a white piece gets to the other side of the board. At that moment, we put another piece on it. Draughts players will say: “White got to king”.

Of course, there are rules to play with a king:

A king can move both forwards and backwards, as far as you would like.

A king can capture over a whole diagonal.

This rule needs a little explanation: for a king to capture, the captured piece does not need to be directly adjacent to the king. And the king can jump to any available field after the captured piece.

Just like with a normal piece, capturing with a king is obligatory.

Exercise 3

Again, you'll find three diagrams, with white to play. Color the possible landing fields for the white king, after the capture. Use an arrow to designate the field you would land the king.

DIAGRAM 10

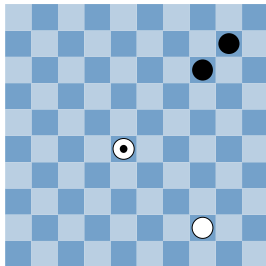


DIAGRAM 11

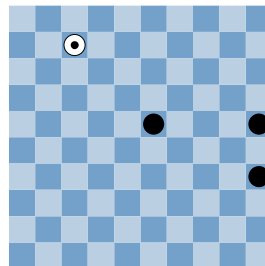
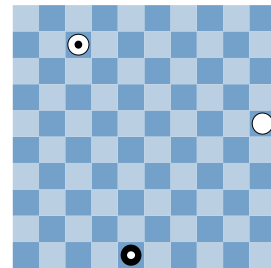


DIAGRAM 12

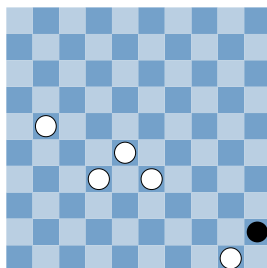


The result of a game

Of course you will want to win the game – that's obviously the most fun. But when can you truly say you've won the game? The rule for winning a game of draughts is:

 *You win when your opponent is out of moves.*

DIAGRAM 13



In DIAGRAM 13, most black pieces have been captured. The black piece in the bottom right corner can't make a move. Black is out of moves, and has therefore lost the game.

Apart from winning or losing, a draw is also possible outcome:

 *If neither of the players can win the game, it's a draw.*



Exercise 4 Predict the result!

Below three games are in progress. In all three games, it's white's turn. Predict the result for each game: will white win, will black win, or will it be a draw?

Write down your opinion below the diagram.

DIAGRAM 14

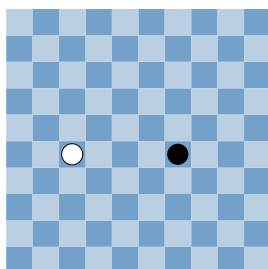


DIAGRAM 15

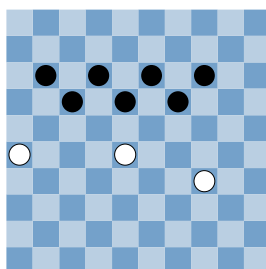
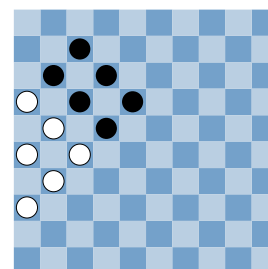


DIAGRAM 16



And now, finally:

Game of the week: let's play some draughts!

Every lesson there's a part in which we play a game that has something to do with draughts. We start off easily: the first game of the week is to play a real draughts match! But of course, after taking this lesson, that was probably the first thing you were thinking of! One of the cool things in draughts is that almost everybody knows how to play the game. You will find an opponent in no time! Maybe one of your friends or family will want to play a game. And remember: play according to the rules you've just mastered!

Lesson 2

Capturing and the majority rule

Having completed the first lesson, you are able to play a game of draughts. Now let's learn to improve your game! For that, the first thing is to learn the exact rules on capturing pieces. In this lesson, you'll learn the majority rule. Also, you'll learn to watch your own pieces. Finally you'll play a game in which your opponent receives a present... your pieces!

Capturing

If you want to win a game of draughts, you will have to capture the opponent's pieces. And that's a fun thing to do! Unfortunately, loads of players sometimes forget to make a capture. Therefore, a good advice is:

 *Always check whether you can make a capture.*

 Exercise 1

Three positions in which white can make a capture. Find the possibility and mark it with an arrow.

DIAGRAM 1

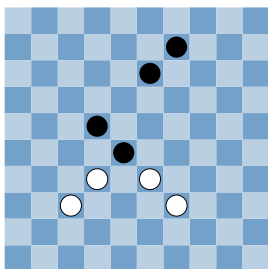


DIAGRAM 2

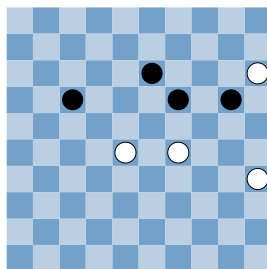


DIAGRAM 3

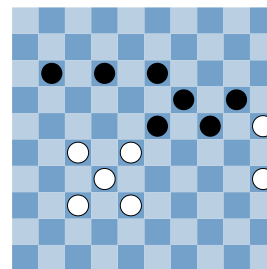
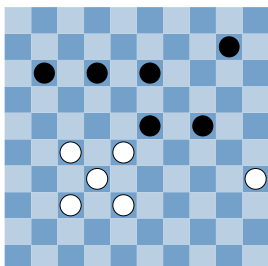


DIAGRAM 4



The majority rule

After white and black both made a capture in DIAGRAM 3, the position of DIAGRAM 4 emerges. It's white's turn again. He's now able to capture a lot of pieces. And that's not only a possibility, it's obligatory to do so. The rule is:

 *You always have to capture as much pieces as possible.*

Or as a shorthand: *majority has priority*. In our example, white is able to capture one, two, three or four pieces. But white doesn't have a choice: according to the majority rule, he has to take four. And white's probably very happy about that!

☀ Exercise 2

Below, you'll find six positions.

- ✓ Create the position on your own board.
- ✓ Find the capturing possibility for white.
- ✓ Draw it in the diagram.
- ✓ But... remember the majority rule!

DIAGRAM 5

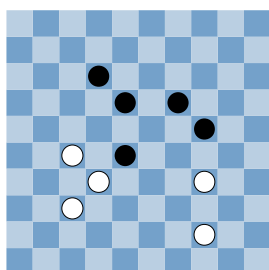


DIAGRAM 6

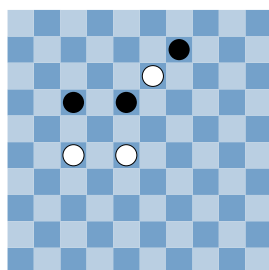


DIAGRAM 7

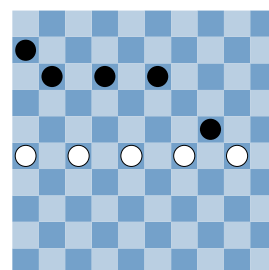


DIAGRAM 8

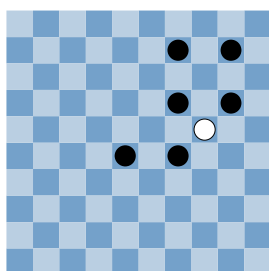


DIAGRAM 9

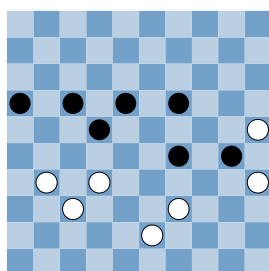
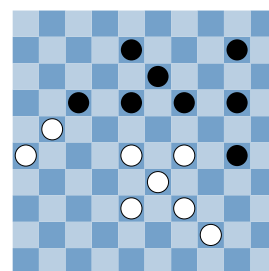


DIAGRAM 10



Check for captures

We're going to have a look at a school tournament in draughts. Michael plays against Sophia. In DIAGRAM 11 the current position is displayed. Get your board and put up this position, because chaos is about to unfold...

Michael, who plays with the white pieces, plays a smart move (**move 1**). He threatens to capture two pieces. Sophia pays attention and quickly moves a piece into the empty space (**move 2**). After that, it's Michael's turn again, and he makes **move 3**.

Did you figure out what's wrong in this story?

If you replayed the story on your board, you must have noticed Michael and Sophia didn't play particularly smart moves. On the contrary: they both forgot to capture pieces! After Michael's first move, Sophia would have been able to capture two pieces with her piece on the right edge of the board. Neither of them noticed the possibility. The teacher who was watching their game stated: "Always check for captures!"

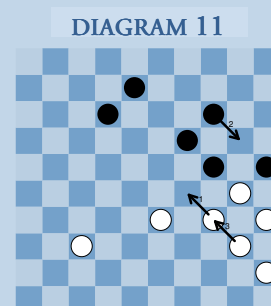
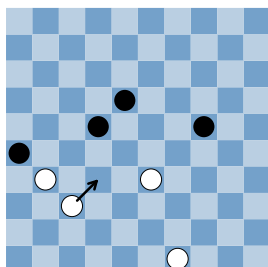


DIAGRAM 12



Watch your own pieces

Capturing pieces is fun... but your opponent loves it as well! You should therefore keep close watch of your own pieces: it's kinda silly to just let them get captured. As an example, watch DIAGRAM 12 and check white's move. "Thanks a bunch!", black yells and he takes three of white's pieces at once!

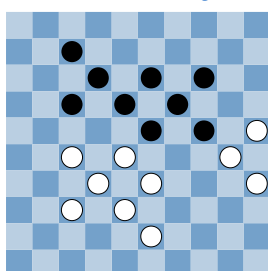
So remember:

👉 Watch your own pieces... don't let them just get captured.

☀ Exercise 3

In DIAGRAM 13 it's white's turn. Think of *three moves* that white should *not* be playing. Mark these moves in the diagram.

DIAGRAM 13





Exercise 4

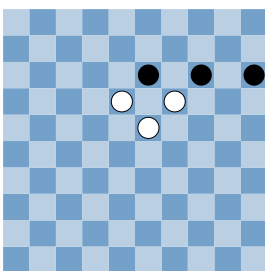
Gotta catch 'em all!

Another three draughts puzzles for you. Use your board and pieces to fill in the blanks under each diagram. For each puzzle you'll have to answer:

- ✓ White to move has to capture ... pieces.
- ✓ After that black captures ... pieces.

Write the answers below the diagram. Don't forget that majority has priority!

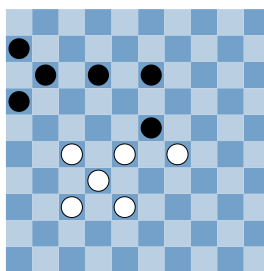
DIAGRAM 14



White captures pieces.

Black captures pieces.

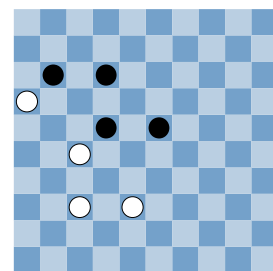
DIAGRAM 15



White captures pieces.

Black captures pieces.

DIAGRAM 16



White captures pieces.

Black captures pieces.

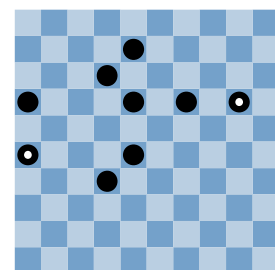
Finished? Quickly return all the pieces to their initial position, because we're going to play the...

Game of the week: give-away draughts

If exercise 3 and 4 were no problem for you, you probably won't have any trouble getting to grips with give-away draughts. And probably you've already heard of it. Give away draughts is just like normal draughts, with one major difference: now the one who can't make any moves actually wins the game!

Did you manage to give away all your pieces? Well done, but let's continue learning the real game!

DIAGRAM 17

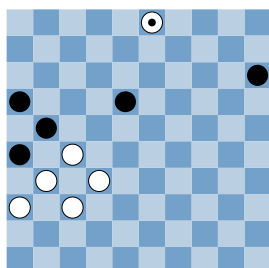


White won the game...

Lesson 3 King!

A king is an awfully strong piece. Kings can cross the whole board and jump pieces like no other. You'll learn the exact way kings can move in this lesson, with special attention for the majority rule. And, as game of the week, we'll play on another type of board!

DIAGRAM 1



The king's role

Do you know what most beginners will want to do when they got a king? Getting another king! But that's not very smart: the king has an important role to play in draughts.

In DIAGRAM 1 Jacob played the white pieces against Emma. Jacob said: "I can't make any good move..." and proceeded to give away two pieces. Emma gave him some important advice afterwards:

 *Use your king, it's a strong piece!*

Exercise 1

Three positions in which you can think of a good move for white. Color the field where you want to move.

DIAGRAM 2

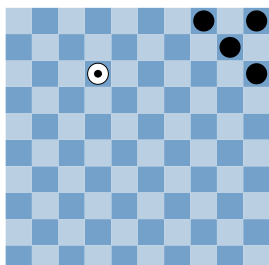


DIAGRAM 3

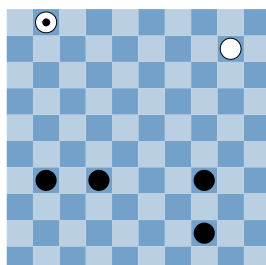
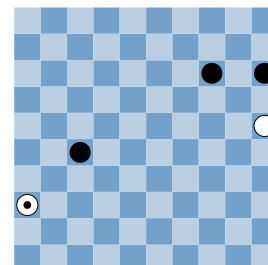


DIAGRAM 4



The majority rule

You must have noticed in DIAGRAM 4, the white king had to capture two pieces. Because a king is just like a piece:

 *Majority has priority.*

It's often hard to see how to make the exact capture with the king. So, give it a good look first before you start to make the move.



Exercise 2

Below are six diagrams to exercise capturing with the king. Try to find the correct capture and mark it with an arrow!

DIAGRAM 5

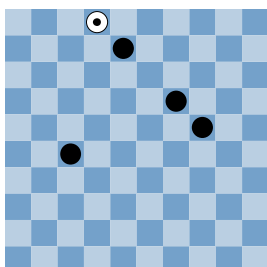


DIAGRAM 6

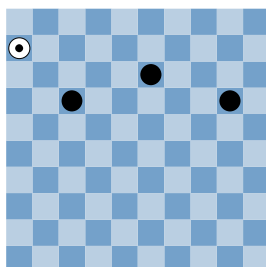


DIAGRAM 7

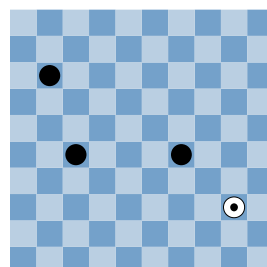


DIAGRAM 8

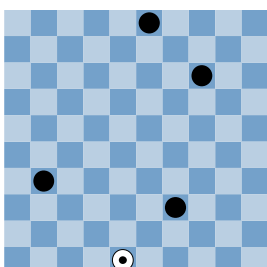


DIAGRAM 9

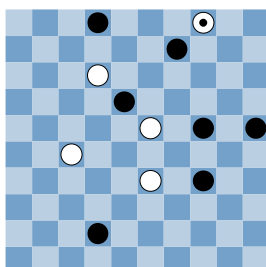
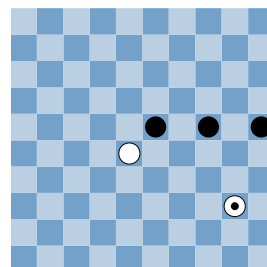


DIAGRAM 10



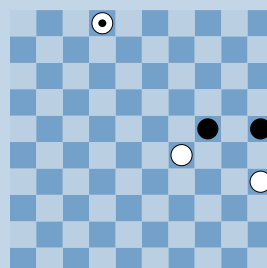
Do king captures have priority over piece captures?

You should know by now that majority captures have priority. Do you think king captures have priority over captures with a piece? A lot of novice players seem to think so. But this is not the case: when you can capture an equal amount of pieces with a king and a piece, you may choose freely. So, be sure to remember:

*King captures do **NOT** have priority over piece captures.*

For DIAGRAM 10 of exercise 2, you should now know the correct solution: the majority capture of the piece has priority over the king capture. And in DIAGRAM 11 below, white can choose freely which capture he makes. What would you do? Make the capture with the king or the piece?

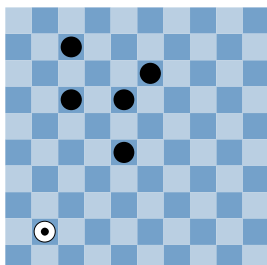
DIAGRAM 11



Exercise 3

In the following positions you can test your knowledge of the rules of the game. The questions are below each diagram.

DIAGRAM 12



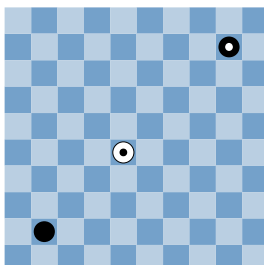
Who's going to win this game?

.....

.....

.....

DIAGRAM 13



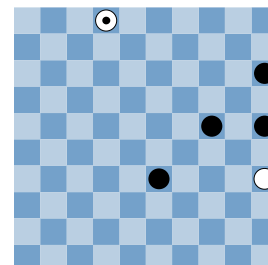
Can white capture two pieces here?

.....

.....

.....

DIAGRAM 14



White forgets to capture! Can black take the white king off the board now?

.....

.....

.....

Exercise 4

Three puzzles to sort out on your board. The white king can capture all black pieces this time! Mark the route the king has to take.

DIAGRAM 15

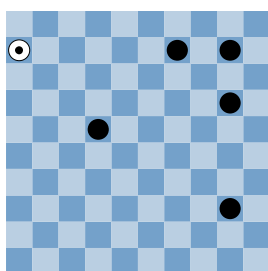


DIAGRAM 16

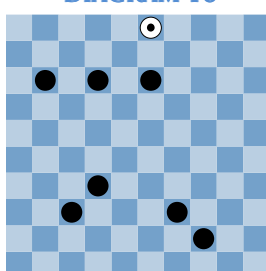
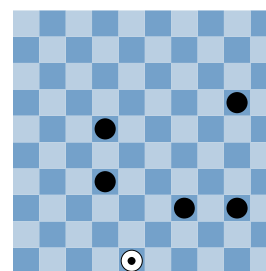
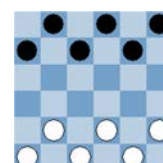


DIAGRAM 17



Game of the week: mini draughts

This is a neat game: play a game of mini draughts, with only six pieces each! You'll have to play on a small board, with only 36 squares. You can make one yourself by covering the edges of the 10x10 board. Or you can draw the squares on a piece of cardboard. The initial position is pictured here. You'll see you'll come across all rules and tricks of the "big" game. A good exercise indeed!



Lesson 4

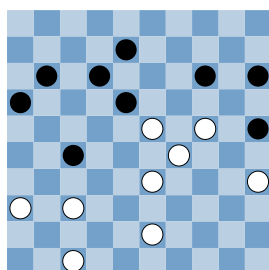
Think, then move

Most beginning players play very quickly. But... draughts is a mind sport, and thus requires serious thinking. Most of the time, you have a lot of possible moves, and of course, you should try to find the smartest one. In this lesson, we'll go over some tips and tricks to find the best move. You'll also get a small class in draughts history, and we'll be playing a game with a delay.

Choosing your move

On each turn, you get to choose a move to play. Most people don't seem to find that very hard, given their speed of play. Sometimes their goal even seems to be who finished his game first! But if you would like to play a better game of draughts, you had better think things over before making your move: this will certainly reduce the amount of mistakes you make!

DIAGRAM 1



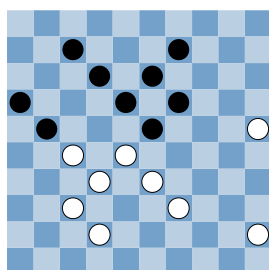
Did you know that in most positions, you can choose between ten different moves? In DIAGRAM 1, white can even do twelve. And if black were to move, he would have eleven possible moves. You might want to do a count every once in a while in your own games. Some good advice:



Always check which moves are possible!

You might even find that you can capture a piece. Or that you're able to go to king.

DIAGRAM 2



Exercise 1

Watch DIAGRAM 2 closely. Use an arrow to point out all possible white moves, even the really silly ones. Then look in the section with answers to the exercises whether you have found them all. Did you succeed? Great! Choose the move you would play and use a colored pencil or a circle to mark that move.

Making plans

In exercise 1, you chose the move you would like to play. You might even have had a special meaning with this particular move. Maybe you wanted to get to king, to go through a hole, or to create a nice figure on the board. Or maybe you even had another idea in mind?

Anyone who plays draughts gets these kind of ideas during the game. And so, even when you lose, you can still have a lot of fun fulfilling your wildest ideas!

However... everybody of course loves to win the game. And pretty figures alone aren't going to suffice for that. You'll have to...

 *Keep paying attention... and play with a clear plan.*



Exercise 2

Lesson 2 and 3 are full of good advice and plans for playing a better game of draughts. You can easily recognize them by this sign:  . Find all advices and write them down here. And if you know of another piece of advice, you're free to add that below as well.

.....

.....

.....

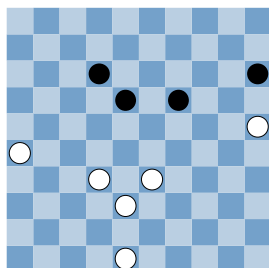
.....

Draughts on a different board

Draughts has been played for a very long time. 4,000 years ago the Egyptians already played a game quite like the one you are learning now. There are draughts players all over the world. The game is especially well known in Africa and Europe, but also in Asia the game's popularity starts to increase. In some countries, the rules of play vary slightly. For example, sometimes it isn't allowed to capture backwards, or the size of the board might differ. Did you know that in Canada draughts is played on a bigger board of 144 squares? And in countries like Russia, Great Britain, Spain and the United States most people play draughts on a smaller board with 64 squares (the chessboard!).



DIAGRAM 3



If you want to win a game, you should try and capture more pieces than your opponent. In DIAGRAM 3 white has succeeded in that objective. He's two pieces ahead. The more pieces you're ahead, the easier it gets to actually win the game.

Exercise 3

This exercise consists of six positions in which should have a good look at what's going on, and then finds a very smart move.

DIAGRAM 4

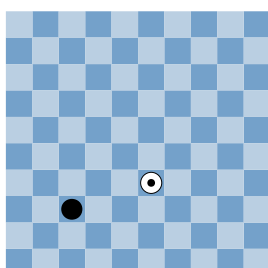


DIAGRAM 5

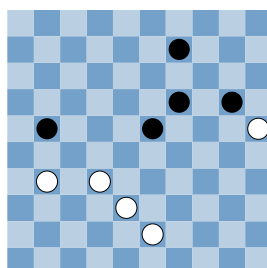


DIAGRAM 6

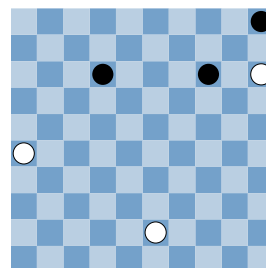


DIAGRAM 7

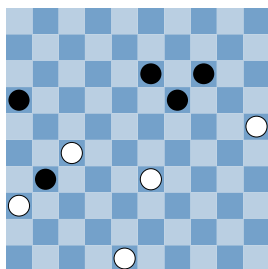


DIAGRAM 8

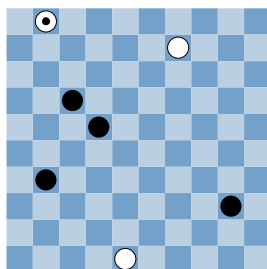


DIAGRAM 9

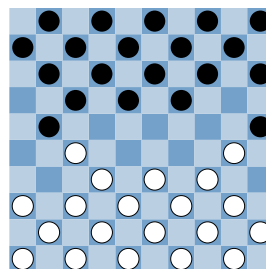
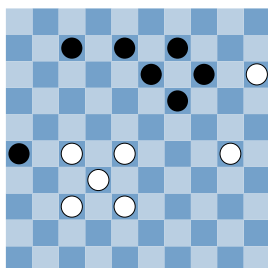


DIAGRAM 10



Think, then move

See what happens in DIAGRAM 10. White is just moving his foremost piece (to get a king!) when he notices black can make a capture then! So white quickly undoes his move and picks another one. Should be possible in a friendly game of draughts, right?

Well, actually... no. You're not allowed to withdraw your moves.

The official rules of play state:

 *Touching a piece equals moving that piece.*

So when you have touched a piece, you are obliged to move with that piece. By the way, you'll also find that you'll actually find better moves when you don't first actually try the move.

The take-home lesson for this week therefore is:

👉 *Think first... and only then make your move.*

Game of the week: draughts with a delay...

We're going to play a game of draughts. You'll need a lot of things this time. Of course, first get an opponent and a board and pieces. But you'll also need an empty diagram and some colored pencils. Play a normal game until white or black has captured ten pieces. After that, you and your opponent can have a good look at the position.

Try to

1. Draw the position in the empty diagram.
2. Write down who played with white, and who played with black.
3. Fill in the blanks:

It's turn

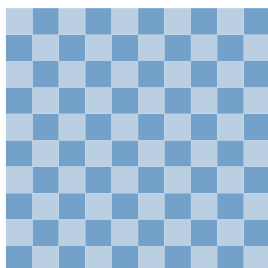
He/she can choose from moves (use arrows to draw these in the diagram).

4. Find two silly moves and color these arrows red.
5. Find two smart moves and color these arrows green.

Of course you can try some moves, as you've jotted down the position in the diagram!

Black:

DIAGRAM 11



White:

Making plans

Theme



What's in this theme?

Lesson 5	Attacking	2.2
Lesson 6	Taking shots	2.6
Lesson 7	Blocking	2.10
Lesson 8	Getting to king	2.14

Lesson 5

Attacking

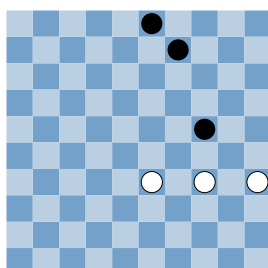
A game of draughts is won by capturing your opponent's pieces. To reach that goal, there are at least four fine plans, all of which will be covered in this theme. Who's aware of these plans will surely play a better game. The first plan is to attack pieces. You'll learn how to attack, but also to defend against an attack. And we'll see Jannes van der Wal showing his skills in a simultaneous exhibition.

Attacking pieces

Sometimes, you're able to win pieces because your opponent gives them away by accident. But most of the time, you will have to come up with something smarter than that. A good idea is to attack pieces: threatening to capture them.

👉 *Always check whether you're able to attack pieces.*

DIAGRAM 1



In DIAGRAM 1 white does not need a lot of time to think. He simply attacks the lone black piece. That's a very strong move. Whichever move black plays, in the next turn, his piece will bite the dust!



Exercise 1

Winning a piece

Three positions stemming from a draughts game.

- ✓ Copy each position on your board.
- ✓ Look for a good attacking move for white.
- ✓ Use an arrow to mark this move.

DIAGRAM 2

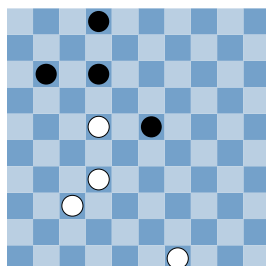


DIAGRAM 3

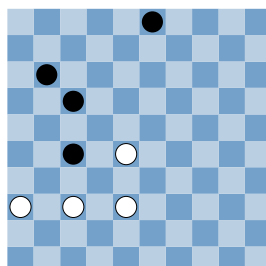
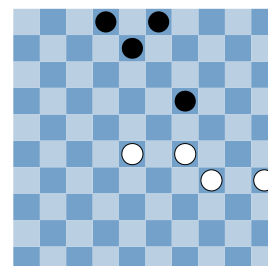


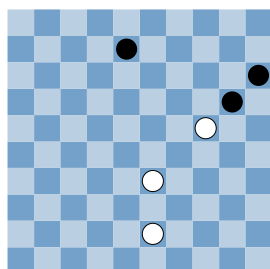
DIAGRAM 4



A simultaneous exhibition with Jannes

Maybe you've once joined a simultaneous exhibition of draughts? They are organized every once in a while, during fairs, markets, or in schools. In a simultaneous exhibition (or simply simul), one really strong player plays a lot of opponents at the same time. The opponents are in a large circle, each with a board in front of them. The simul player walks around, and every time he reaches your board, you're allowed to make your move. The exhibitor makes his move and proceeds to the next board. This continues until all games are finished. Jannes van der Wal, the small grand master from Groningen whom you've heard of already, was loved for his simuls. He played a lot of them, and there were quite a few kids among his opponents. Someone once asked: "Why don't you let one of those boys or girls win, just once?" Jannes replied: "Because that's not fair. They will know when I'm acting. It's already a great effort if they're keeping up with me for a short while." Jannes used to hold the world record for the largest simultaneous exhibition: he once played 225 opponents at the same time. He does still hold another very special record: in June 1996, he played a simul against 85 opponents, mixing draughts and chess! Shortly thereafter Jannes became very ill and in September 1996 he passed away at the age of 39.

DIAGRAM 5



Defending

"Anything you can do, I can do better", is black's line of thought. In DIAGRAM 5 he just attacked three white pieces, he threatens to capture them all. Luckily, white is able to defend himself quite well. He even has three options here:

1. walking away with his foremost piece;
2. closing up the hole in his defense;
3. intercepting, ensuring he can capture the attacking piece in return.

Often there's a good way to defend against an attack. But of course, to defend, you first have to spot the threat. So:

👉 *Always check whether you are being attacked... and find the best possible defense.*



Exercise 2 Find the best defense.

- ✓ Copy each position to your board.
- ✓ Try to find black's attacking plan.
- ✓ Think of a defense for white. Draw this move in the diagram.

DIAGRAM 6

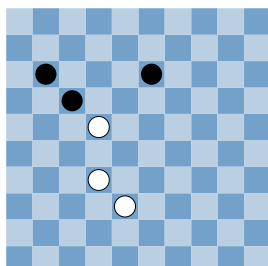


DIAGRAM 7

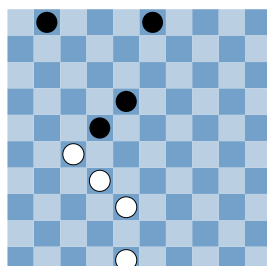
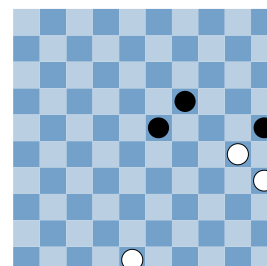


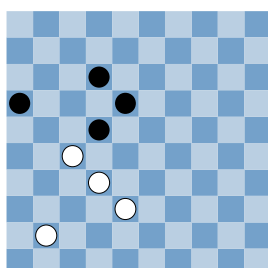
DIAGRAM 8



Exchanging

Sometimes there's no way to save your piece from being captured. That doesn't have to be a problem... as long as you manage to capture one of your opponents' pieces in return! We call that an exchange. In DIAGRAM 8 of exercise 2 there's already a nice example of an exchange.

DIAGRAM 9



In DIAGRAM 9 another example is displayed, let's play along on your board. White's foremost piece is in trouble. It's under attack. Is white still able to defend? Yes, as he can use an exchange for that. In an exchange, you give away something and receive something of equal value in return.

In DIAGRAM 9 there are two possible exchanges for white:

- ✓ With his foremost piece: black has to make a capture, and white captures that piece.
- ✓ Intercept with his bottommost piece: same story all over again. It's clear as day: an exchange is a perfect way to defend your pieces.



Exercise 3 Attacking and defending.

Six positions in which white is able to attack... or has to defend himself. It's up to you to find the best move.

DIAGRAM 10

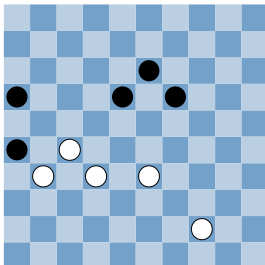


DIAGRAM 11

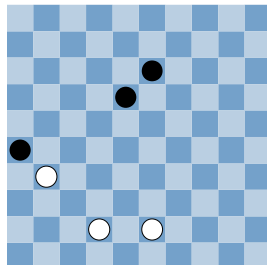


DIAGRAM 12

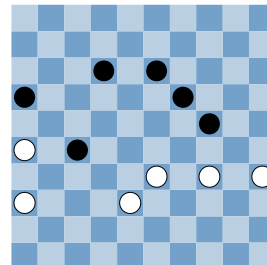


DIAGRAM 13

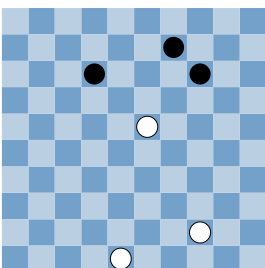


DIAGRAM 14

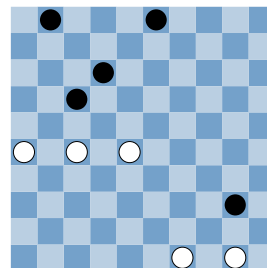
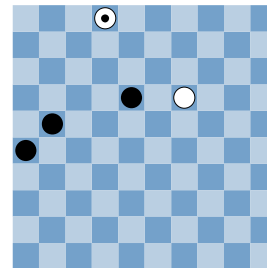


DIAGRAM 15

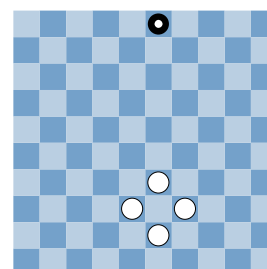


Game of the week: a king's chase

A king is great for attacking pieces. You might have noticed that in the previous exercise already. This game of the week is a game in which the king is going to chase pieces.

Copy the position of DIAGRAM 16 to your board: a black king against four white pieces. In this game you can earn four points for each piece that safely reaches the other side of the board. Black earns points for each piece he captures. When all remaining pieces have become kings, it's game over. Then change colors and start over, and see whether you can do better!

DIAGRAM 16

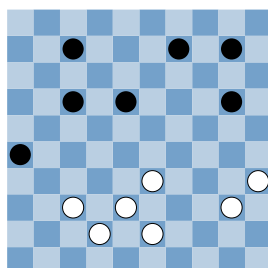


Lesson 6

Taking shots

Some draughts players dream about giving away all but one piece, and then use this piece to make one colossal capture. Maybe you'll succeed in that some time. In this lesson, you'll learn how to create this kind of situations, which we'll call shots (or combinations). You will also create your own shot. And we'll introduce a tenfold world champion in draughts.

DIAGRAM 1



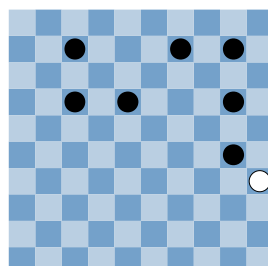
Taking shots

Quickly copy the position in DIAGRAM 1 to your board. White is going to win this game... by first giving away six pieces!

Try to give away as much pieces as possible:

1. First four pieces at the same time (beware: black won't get a king!).
2. Then another piece (the right way!).
3. And then another piece.

DIAGRAM 2



Did you succeed? Your reward is in DIAGRAM 2. What's happening? Is this real? Yes, you're able to capture all of black's seven remaining pieces now! That was truly a magnificent shot!

Taking shots is: giving away pieces... and capturing some pieces in return.

Each game is full of shots. Sometimes they're quite hard, just like the combination we've just shown you. But shots aren't always that hard. Sometimes you just give away one piece to capture two or three pieces of your opponent.

Anyone can find shots... as long as you keep looking for them!

Another piece of advice:

👉 *Always keep an eye open for shots.*

 Exercise 1

Six combinations for you to find. In each position, white gives a way one piece to capture some of black's pieces. Use arrows to mark the correct moves.

DIAGRAM 3

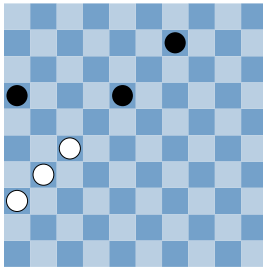


DIAGRAM 4

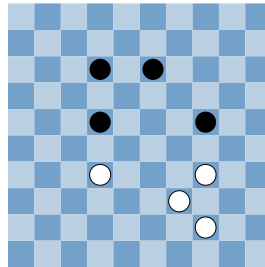


DIAGRAM 5

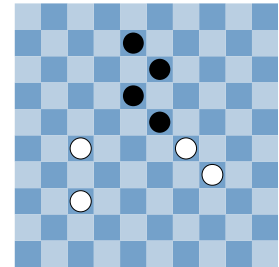


DIAGRAM 6

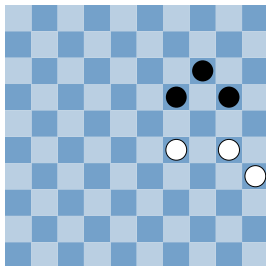


DIAGRAM 7

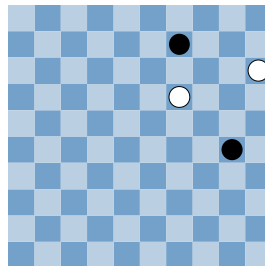
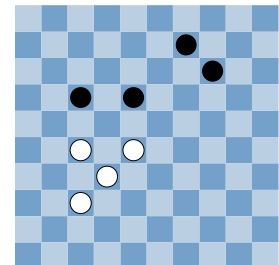


DIAGRAM 8



A tenfold world champion

One of the best draughts players worldwide is the Russian Alexei Chizhov, a tenfold (!) world champion. Here you'll see him play another grandmaster, Alexander Baljakin (originally from Belarus, now living in the Netherlands). Baljakin and Chizhov played many matches, and this game is from the 1996 world championship. Alexander, who plays white, just made a mistake. Alexei is going to take a shot to king: he gives away three of his pieces, and captures three white pieces in return... with a king as a bonus. After this victory, Chizhov proceeded to win the world championship, a great effort!

DIAGRAM 9

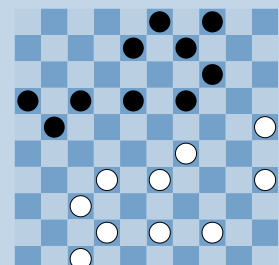
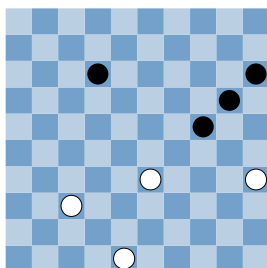


DIAGRAM 10



Threatened by a shot

In DIAGRAM 10 black has played a very clever move: he threatens with a shot. Did you spot it? Luckily, white is able to just move away his foremost piece, preventing the combination.

Taking shots is one of the best parts in draughts. Every player wants to carry out one or two in a game. That also applies to your opponent. Don't let yourself get caught off guard:



Beware of shots at all times!



Exercise 2

Three opponents who would love to take a shot. How are you going to prevent that?

- ✓ Copy each position to your board.
- ✓ Try to find black's plan.
- ✓ Think of a good defense for white. Mark that move with an arrow.

DIAGRAM 11

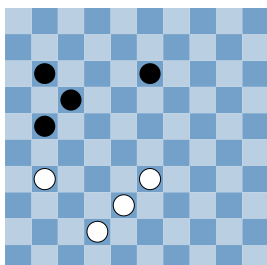


DIAGRAM 12

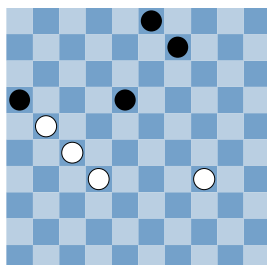


DIAGRAM 13

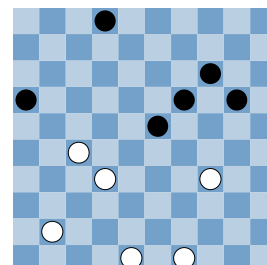
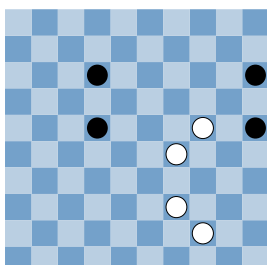


DIAGRAM 14



Giving away more pieces

In DIAGRAM 14 white comes up with a brilliant idea: he gives not one, but two pieces. And then captures two or three black pieces. Great shot!



Exercise 3

Six diagrams to test your skills. In some positions white to move can make a shot... but sometimes you will have to defend yourself against one! Again, use an arrow to mark the best move.

DIAGRAM 15

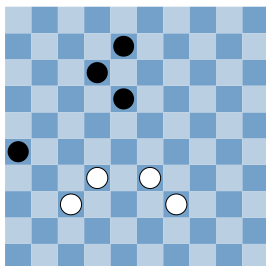


DIAGRAM 16

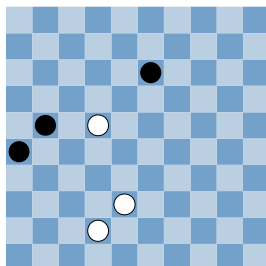


DIAGRAM 17

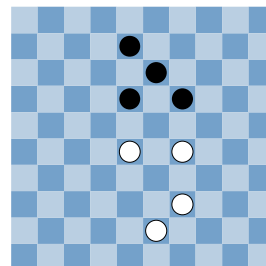


DIAGRAM 18

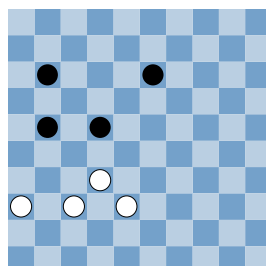


DIAGRAM 19

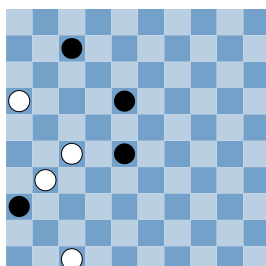
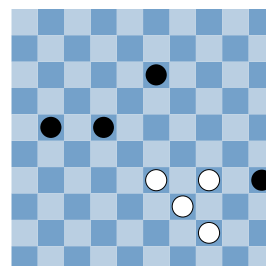


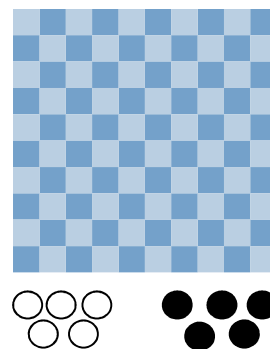
DIAGRAM 20



Game of the week: create your own combination

There's a countless number of combinations. Each game you will discover new shots. Some draughts players like to come up with their own draughts puzzles, usually including a cool combination. We'll give you an empty diagram with five pieces for each side. It's your task to come up with your own shot. You can use your board to try different positions. If you're happy with your idea, draw the position into the empty diagram. And of course, ask other pupils what they have devised. Do you like their combinations as well?

DIAGRAM

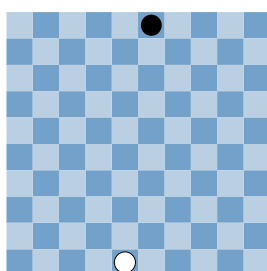


Lesson 7

Blocking

Sometimes there's no other way than to give away a piece, whether you like it or not. Your pieces have then been blocked. Blocking is one of the most important plans in draughts. You might well use this plan in a tournament! A plan to remember... and to practice in our game of the week!

DIAGRAM 1



Exercise 1

Let's start off with a game for two players. Get your board out, put the pieces in the position of DIAGRAM 1 and start playing! Let's see who wins. Play the game twice: once with white, and the second time with black.

Blocking

If in exercise 1 you both got a king, the game probably ended in a draw. But maybe you encountered a position like DIAGRAM 2. Somewhere along the road to king the pieces met. And white's last move blocked black's piece. This essentially is blocking: maneuvering in such a way that your opponent will have to give away his pieces.

So here's another plan for you:

 *Try to block your opponent!*

Exercise 2 Block the black pieces

It's not easy to block your opponent. Copy the following three positions to your board and try to discover the best move. Of course, make sure whether after that move the game is really won for white. Because black only loses when his last piece is off the board!

DIAGRAM 3

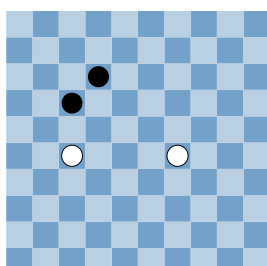


DIAGRAM 4

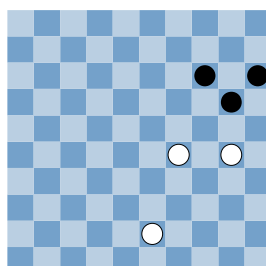
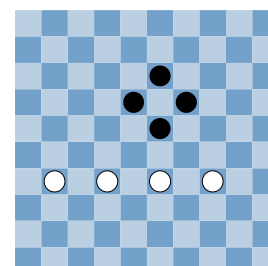


DIAGRAM 5

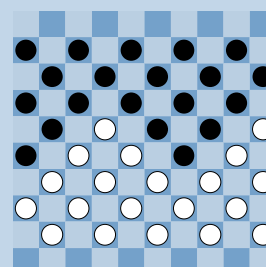


School draughts tournament

Did you ever participate in a school draughts tournament? Then you're pretty good! In these tournaments school teams of four or five participants compete to win the town's championship. In most countries, thousands of kids participate yearly in these tournaments. Usually, they're very exciting and fun games, with lots of spectators cheering you on.

In DIAGRAM 6 there's a game stemming from a school draughts tournament. You can easily spot that they haven't played a lot of draughts games, because not a single piece has yet been captured! They must have forget to capture a piece, or didn't dare to make any exchanges. And there's something else going on. It's white's turn... but he's completely blocked! He asked the referee whether it's a draw now... But unfortunately for white, the rules of play say: if you don't have any moves left, you've lost the game.

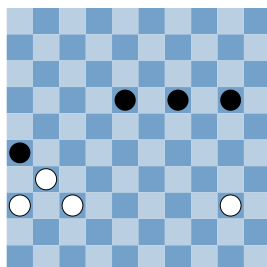
DIAGRAM 6



Escaping

A witty opponent will try to block you. But paying attention can certainly prevent that from happening:

DIAGRAM 7



⚡ *Don't allow your pieces to get blocked!*

In DIAGRAM 7 white needs to be very careful. Black is planning a strong move to block the white pieces on the left side of the board. Did you notice the threat? Then you can try to defend yourself against that. White can do that by playing his foremost piece, and the game will continue.

Watch your step!

☀ Exercise 3

In the next three positions white again needs to be very careful, otherwise he will lose the game in no-time.

- ✓ Copy the position to your board.
- ✓ Find the best move. Don't be scared to try out a few moves.
- ✓ Use an arrow to mark the best move in the diagram.

DIAGRAM 8

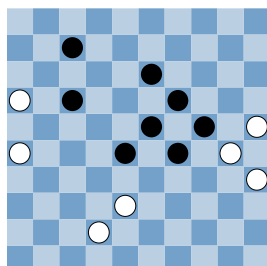


DIAGRAM 9

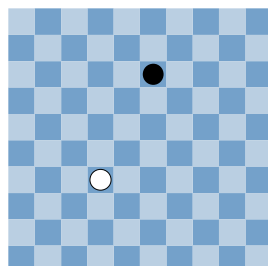
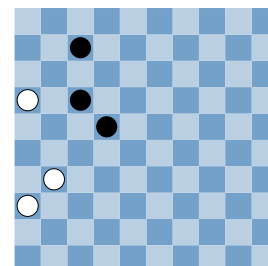


DIAGRAM 10



☀ Exercise 4

Six positions in which white might be able to block black... but should also be watching his own pieces! Find the best move on your board and mark it in the diagram.

DIAGRAM 11

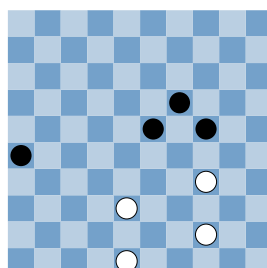


DIAGRAM 12

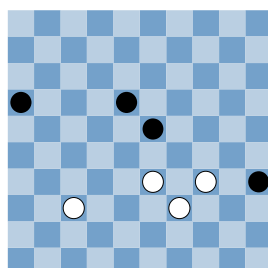


DIAGRAM 13

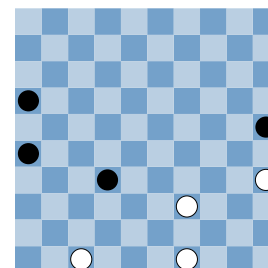


DIAGRAM 14

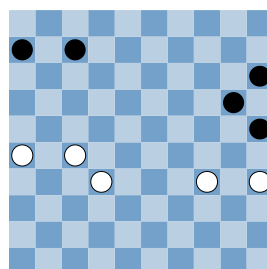


DIAGRAM 15

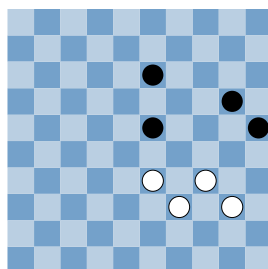
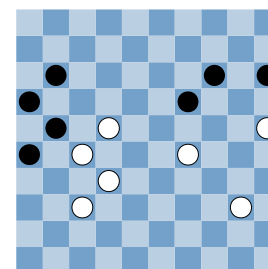


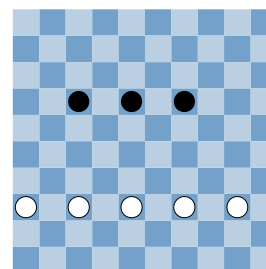
DIAGRAM 16



Game of the week: winning a winning position

Even when you're ahead in pieces, you still have to pay attention. Before you know it, your opponent escapes to a draw! In DIAGRAM 17 white is two pieces ahead. Find an opponent and continue the game from here. White wins when he captures all pieces, but black wins if he manages to get to a king. You won't forget to switch colors after the game, right?

DIAGRAM 17



Lesson 8

Getting a king

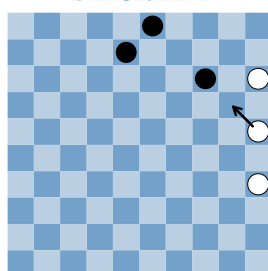
Kings aren't called kings for nothing. A king is very strong, and each draughts player will want to get one. Even Harm Wiersma, a famous draughts player, who'll show us the power of the king. We're going to try and get kings ourselves... and of course we'll make sure our opponent doesn't!

Getting a king

You've received a lot of good advice. On capturing, attacking, taking shots and blocking. But the next plan is already familiar to everyone, from novice to champ. It's simply a perfect plan. Let's hear it from Harm Wiersma:

👉 *Always see whether you can get a king!*

DIAGRAM 1



A king is very versatile. It can attack, make shots, block... and so on. A king is so valuable that you might want to invest a few pieces into getting it. In DIAGRAM 1 there's an example of that. White decides to give away a piece. Draughts players call that a sacrifice. After that, the road to king is clear!

☀ Exercise 1 The road to king

Again, three diagram for you. Which move would you play to get a king quickly? Use an arrow to mark the move you would play.

DIAGRAM 2

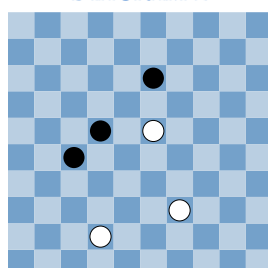


DIAGRAM 3

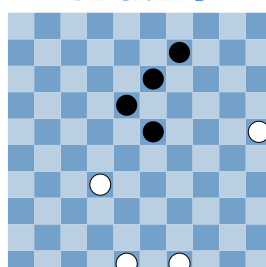
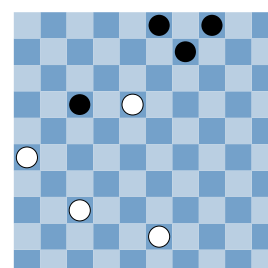


DIAGRAM 4



Harm Wiersma

You just got an advice from Harm Wiersma. He's truly an expert in the game: he's been world champion for six times. Harm learned to play draughts when he was 9 years old. At the age of 13, Harm already played in the Dutch championship! He tells us this story:

"In my first championship, I had a cushion on my chair to be able to see the board. Most of my opponents where three to four times my age. I don't really remember the games I've played, but I do recall that on a Saturday I rushed home directly after my game: I didn't want to miss my favorite TV show!"

In DIAGRAM 5 Harm shows us a nice combination with a king. It starts with whites middle foremost piece. Play along on your board! Did you see that white has 2 ways to take the combination?

DIAGRAM 5

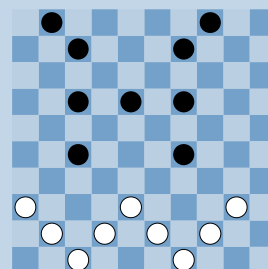
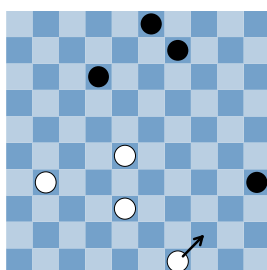


DIAGRAM 6



Stopping

Every player would love to get a king. But it is also of utmost importance to ensure your opponent isn't able to just breach your defenses without effort.



Don't let your opponent get a king!

In DIAGRAM 6, white understood that completely. He successfully stops the black piece before he himself tries to get a king.



Exercise 2

In all these positions, black wants to get a king.

- ✓ Copy the position to your board.
- ✓ Find black's plan. Point this out with a red arrow.
- ✓ Find a good move for white. Use a green arrow to mark that move.

DIAGRAM 7

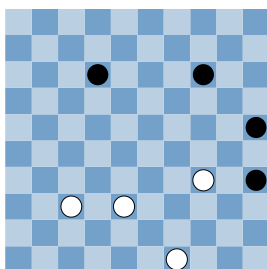


DIAGRAM 8

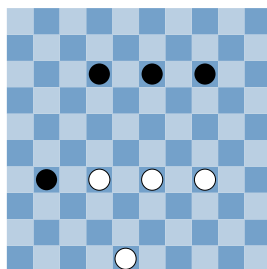
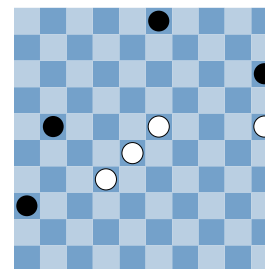


DIAGRAM 9



All plans thrown together

We have almost reached the end of the second theme. You've learned four new plans: blocking, attacking, taking shots and getting to king. You can use these in each draughts game... but your opponent can as well!

Exercise 3

Nine positions in which “something” is going on. White has to come up with a strong move to win the game... or not to lose it. Try to find the correct move and mark that in the diagram.

DIAGRAM 10

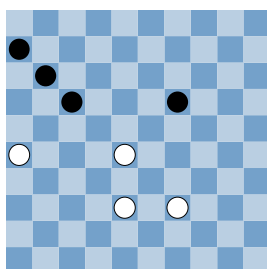


DIAGRAM 11

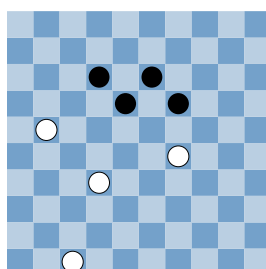


DIAGRAM 12

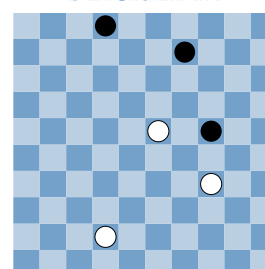


DIAGRAM 13

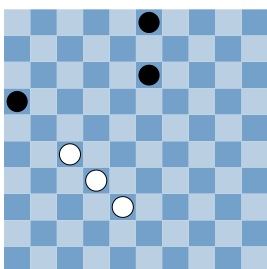


DIAGRAM 14

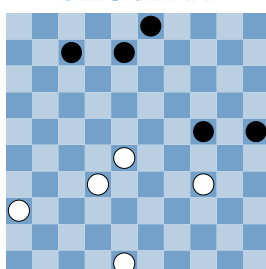


DIAGRAM 15

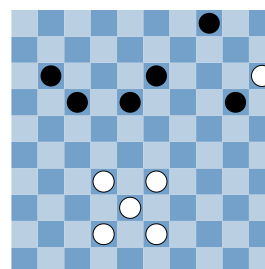


DIAGRAM 16

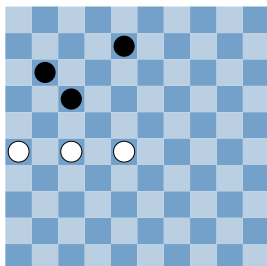


DIAGRAM 17

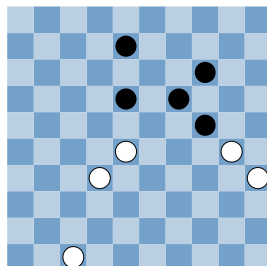
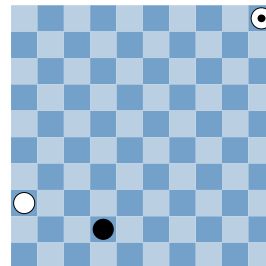


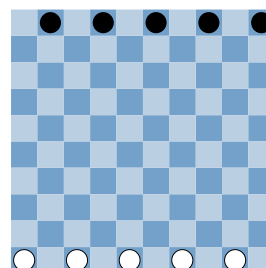
DIAGRAM 18



Game of the week: first to king wins!

Of course, getting first to king in a normal game doesn't always lead to a win. But this is a nice game to test your skills. Both players start with five pieces on the bottom row. Who can get to king first? As always, switch colors after every game.

DIAGRAM 19



Better draughts

Theme

3

What's in this theme?

Lesson 9	Developing	3.2
Lesson 10	The endgame	3.6
Lesson 11	All kinds of shots	3.10
Lesson 12	Good game!	3.14

Lesson 9

Developing

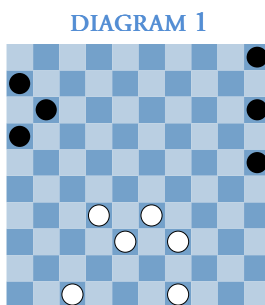
During a draughts game, you're continuously developing your position. You're trying to move your pieces to have them ready to attack, make shots, get a king, or block your opponent. Sometimes you perform exchanges and sacrifices. And of course, you're always watching your opponent closely.

In this lesson we'll tell you what to think off when developing your position. We'll see how kids play... and we'll meet another famous draughts player: Ton Sijbrands.

All pieces to the edge?

 Exercise 1

In DIAGRAM 1 a game is in progress. Finish the game with someone else. Draw lots to decide who's playing white and who's playing black.



Who won the game? White surely had the best odds. The black player started off with all his pieces on the edge of the board, with a massive void in the center of the board. White must have been able to just move through there, on his way to get a strong king.

A lot of novices move their pieces to the edge of the board. If you're one of them, some good advice:

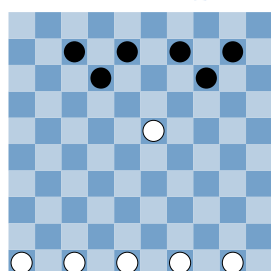
 *Try to move your pieces towards the center of the board.*

Working together

When in a soccer team all players decide it's time for a solo, they will seldom score a goal. In draughts, similar laws apply:

 *Your pieces should work together.*

DIAGRAM 2



Notice the lonely white piece in DIAGRAM 2? He wanted to go to king on his own. He had better not go alone, but in a group. Because now black can attack the lone ranger and devour it... by letting his pieces work together!



Exercise 2

Let's build a position ourselves. Your opponents are waiting for you. They are all playing white. You have five black pieces in your hands.

- ✓ Try to look for weak spots in the white position.
- ✓ Put your black pieces on the board in the best way possible.
- ✓ Find someone to play the resulting position. White begins.

DIAGRAM 3

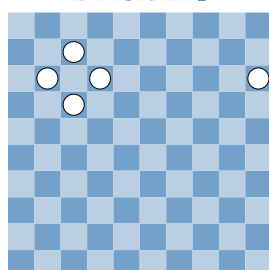


DIAGRAM 4

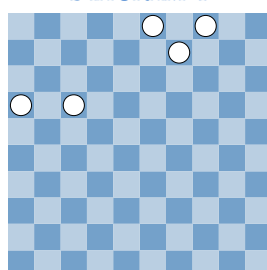
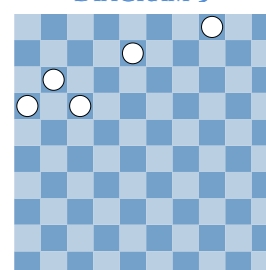


DIAGRAM 5



Exercise 3

3a

Watch DIAGRAM 2 again. White has five pieces on the bottommost row. You'll find that a lot of beginners play like that. What do you think about that?

An advantage is:

.....

A disadvantage is:

.....

3b

Let's analyze six other ways to play draughts. You'll see that in kids' games, three of them occur a lot. Which ones are they? You may also write down why you think that is the case.

- playing fast
- thinking for a long time
- making exchanges and shots
- forgetting to capture
- giving away pieces carelessly
- moving pieces towards the center of the board
-
-
-

Ton Sijbrands

Ton Sijbrands is one of the best draughts players ever. In his youth, he played soccer at Ajax Amsterdam, but he had even more talent for draughts... Consider how brilliant he must have been at draughts then!

Ton became world champion in 1972 and defended his title in 1973, but after that, he almost never participated anymore in major tournaments. He does keep in touch with draughts by writing books and newspaper columns, for example in the Dutch newspaper de Volkskrant.

Already in 1964 Ton wins his first important title: he becomes Dutch youth champion. In DIAGRAM 6 you'll see him play the black pieces. Ton developed his position superiorly, because white is almost entirely blocked... Can you figure out what happens when white attacks black's foremost piece?

DIAGRAM 6

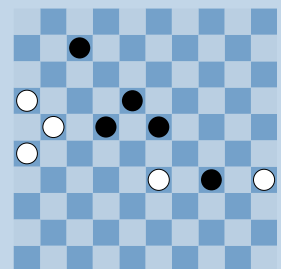
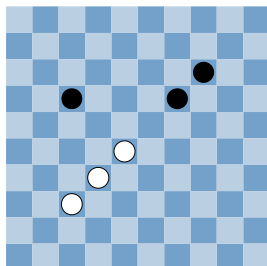


DIAGRAM 7



Making exchanges

You've already learned how to make exchanges. In DIAGRAM 7 we'll give another example. White gives away one piece and captures a piece in return. An exchange might be just as strong as a normal move. It's usually a great way to develop your position.

Return to the lessons on attacking, blocking and getting to king. In those lessons, we've also included a few exchanges. And what about the Ton Sijbrands' position? After the white attack, black has a powerful exchange!



Check if there's a good opportunity to make an exchange.



Exercise 4

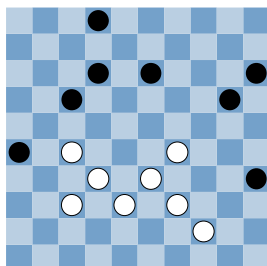
4a

In DIAGRAM 6, white is able to play moves. And where are the exchanges? Mark these with an arrow. Pick your favorite move and play the position against someone.

4b

Right from the start of the game, there are opportunities to make exchanges. At each opening move of white, black is able to give a piece and capture one in return. Figure out how that works.

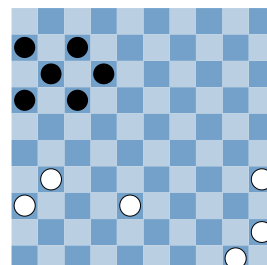
DIAGRAM 8



Game of the week: repairing your position

In DIAGRAM 9, there's a position that needs some repairing before you can play it against one of your fellow students. You can shift your pieces horizontally (so forwards or backwards is not allowed) until you're OK with your position. And then... let's play draughts!

DIAGRAM 9



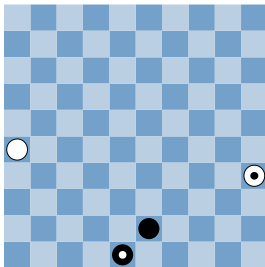
Lesson 10

The endgame

Winning a draughts game usually proceeds step by step. First you might win a piece, then another... That way you slowly build an advantage. And only in the endgame you can try to convert this advantage into a win. And when you manage to get a king, there's a good chance you're able to win the endgame.

You'll see how beautiful and surprising the endgame in draughts can be!

DIAGRAM 1



An unexpected result

Let's broadcast a school draughts tournament. In DIAGRAM 1, Emma (white) plays Daniel (black). The endgame is in full swing. It's very exciting, because the position is completely equal!

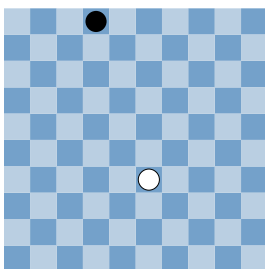
Daniel is on his way to a second king. Is he going to win the game? Then Emma makes a move... and Daniel stares open-mouthed at the board... Then he proceeds to shake Emma's hand and says: "Congratulations, I resign!"



Exercise 1

Why did Daniel resign? Emma must have played a beautiful move. Try to find this move on your own board, and draw it in the diagram!

DIAGRAM 2



Thinking ahead

In the endgame, you'll have to play very carefully to win... or not to lose the game. Check DIAGRAM 2. If white moves left to try and block black, he will be blocked himself, and will lose the game. Did you see that without touching the pieces? Great!

Did you also spot the best move for white? Yes, he should play rightwards: he will move past the black piece, and eventually even win the game!



Try to think ahead.

Exercise 2

Six endgames in which applies: white to play and win!

DIAGRAM 3

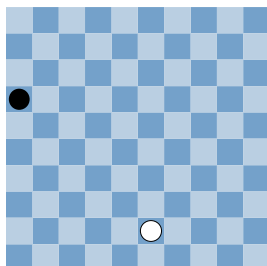


DIAGRAM 4

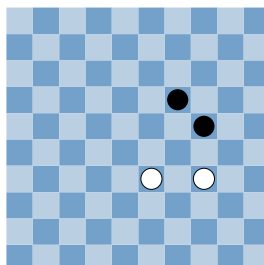


DIAGRAM 5

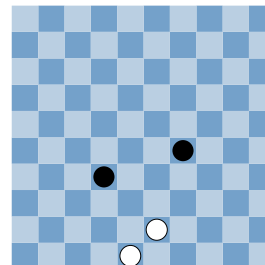


DIAGRAM 6

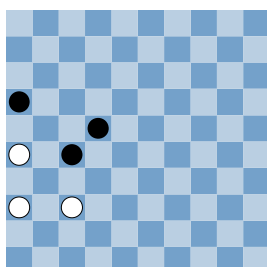


DIAGRAM 7

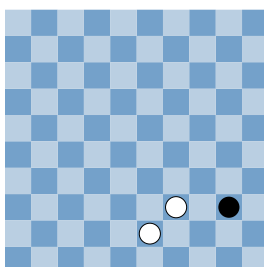
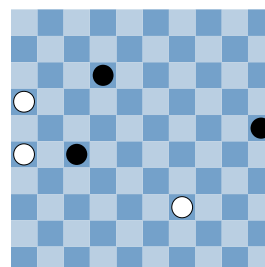


DIAGRAM 8



The king's role

With a king you're able to do a multitude of things: capturing, attacking, taking shots, blocking, exchanging and you might even sacrifice it. It makes perfect sense that you should try to get a thing. We said it in lesson 3 already, but let's repeat:

 *Use your king, it's a strong piece!*





Exercise 3

Six positions in which white plays a powerful move. Try to find the move on your board! Do you also manage to see how the game continues after the correct move?

DIAGRAM 9

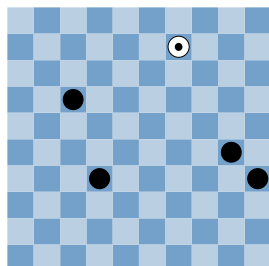


DIAGRAM 10

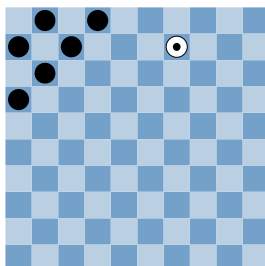


DIAGRAM 11

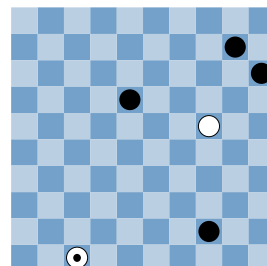


DIAGRAM 12

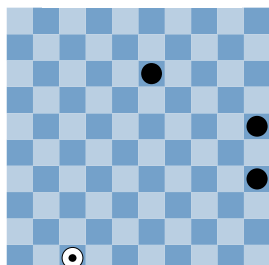


DIAGRAM 13

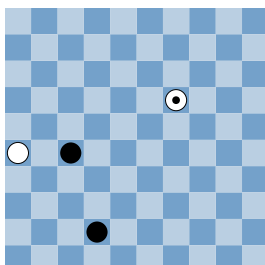
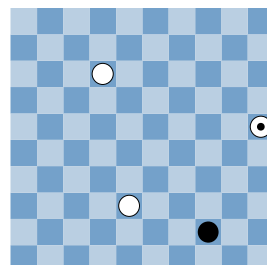


DIAGRAM 14



Karen van Lith

Karen van Lith used to be among the top draughts players. She managed to become Dutch champion for eleven consecutive years, and also defeated quite a few male grandmasters.

Here we'll show you how she managed to win her tenth title in 1995.

Karen's biggest rival Erna Wanders is one piece behind in the endgame, but she's threatening to get a king (and a draw). Then Karen (with the black pieces!) plays a very surprising move: she gives away two pieces and captures only one in return. But you know what? This was the last move of the game, as Erna resigned!

Try to find why Karen will win the endgame after her surprising sacrifice!

DIAGRAM 15

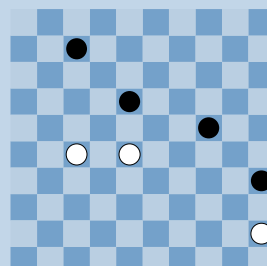
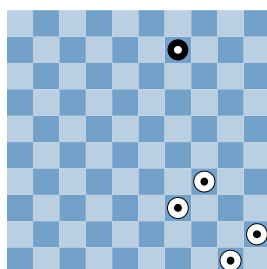


DIAGRAM 16



Win or draw?

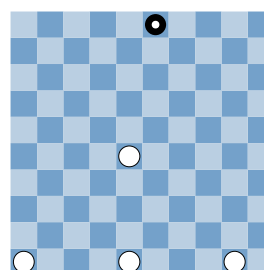
Because the king is such a strong piece, you'd better try and catch it quickly, like in DIAGRAM 14 of the previous exercise. But you won't always succeed in capturing a king. If your opponent is unable to do that as well, the game will end in a draw.

In DIAGRAM 16, white has four kings, while black only has one. White has a winning position here. Whichever move black plays, white will always catch his king. Figure out how that works!

Game of the week: catch the king!

Who defends himself well, won't lose a lot of games in draughts. Even three kings are usually not enough to beat one king. But four kings can always catch one king. In DIAGRAM 17, this is going to take quite a while. Continue play from this position. White tries to get to king and win the game, while black should try to prevent that.

DIAGRAM 17



Lesson 11

All kinds of shots

“I see a shot!” is a common phrase when you're in the vicinity of draughts players. In lesson 6 you've already learned how to make shots: giving away pieces to capture some more yourself afterwards. Fun to do and it will surely help you win the game.

Let's practice that again. Just as long until you can proudly say: “I've won by making a great shot!”.



Exercise 1

Let's start off with six easy shots. Try to not use a board this time to find the combination. If you've succeeded, see whether you were right using your board. Use arrows to mark the correct moves. But... take care! Sometimes you can't make a shot, but instead you have to defend yourself against a real threat!

DIAGRAM 1

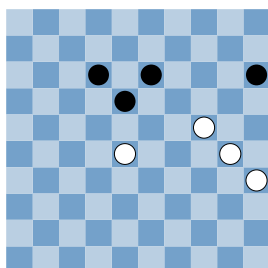


DIAGRAM 2

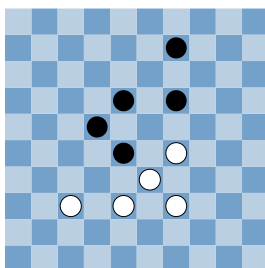


DIAGRAM 3

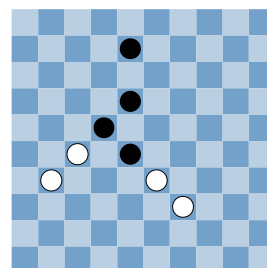


DIAGRAM 4

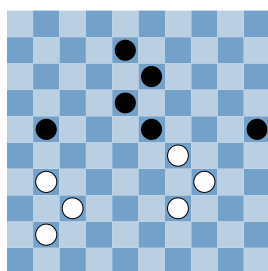


DIAGRAM 5

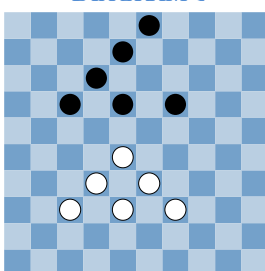


DIAGRAM 6

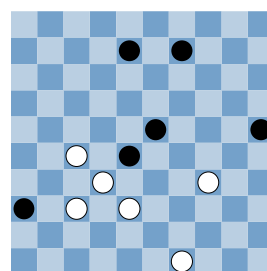
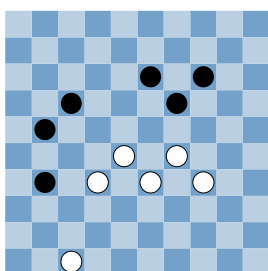


DIAGRAM 7



Giving away more pieces...

In DIAGRAM 6, white first gave away one piece, and then another one. If you think about giving away some pieces, you might find a surprising shot. Like in DIAGRAM 7. White manages to find a clever combination, in which the majority rule comes in handy!



Exercise 2

Don't be too careful with the white pieces in the next exercise... Giving away some might well lead to success!

DIAGRAM 8

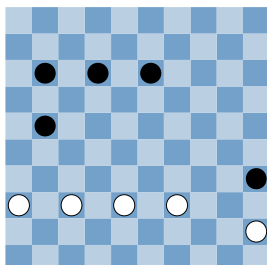


DIAGRAM 9

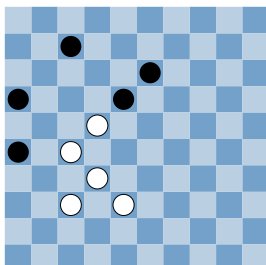


DIAGRAM 10

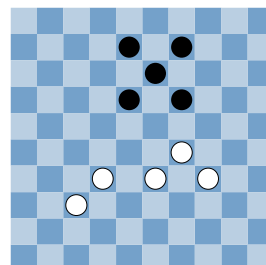


DIAGRAM 11

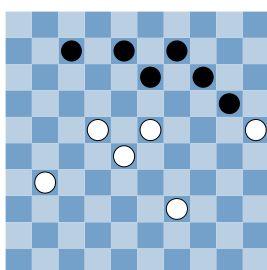


DIAGRAM 12

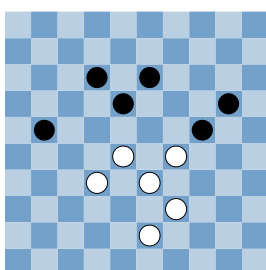


DIAGRAM 13

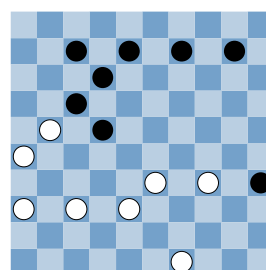
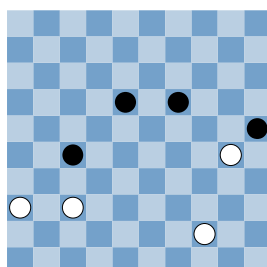


DIAGRAM 14



A wrong attack...

In DIAGRAM 14, black's on the offense. He threatens to capture a piece at the next move. But he does give white an opportunity to think of a cunning reply, since black has a mandatory capture at the next move. And white laughs last: he'll capture three black pieces! After the game he has some good advice for his opponent:



When you make an attacking move, always watch for shots.

Exercise 3

Six positions in which black attacks incautiously and is caught off guard. Find the winning move for white. Sometimes, you can make use of the majority rule.

DIAGRAM 15

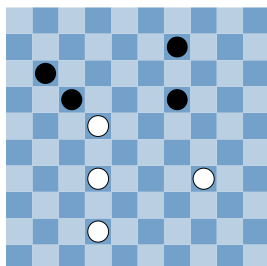


DIAGRAM 16

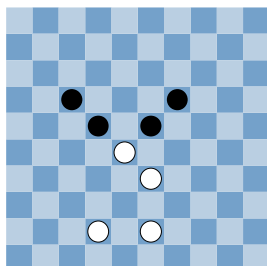


DIAGRAM 17

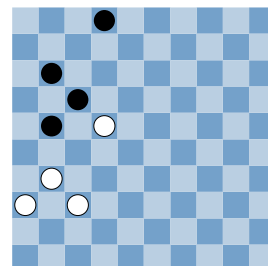


DIAGRAM 18

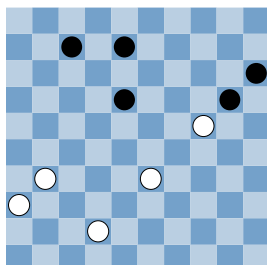


DIAGRAM 19

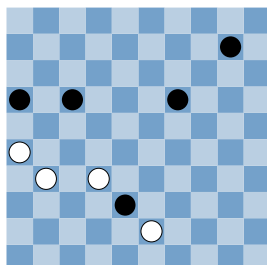


DIAGRAM 20

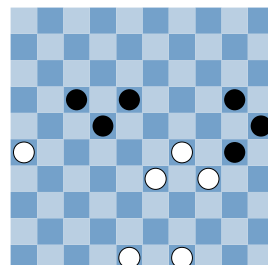
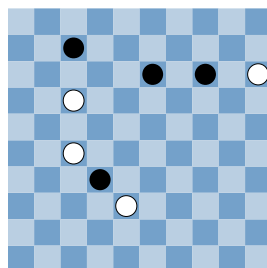


DIAGRAM 21



Stick move

In DIAGRAM 20, white wins with a stick move. He 'sticks' his piece to a black one. In DIAGRAM 21 we see another example. Black cleverly moved between two white pieces. So he thinks. But in reality, he walked right into a trap. White makes a stick move with his rightmost piece... and captures three black pieces! That stick move might come in handy sometimes...

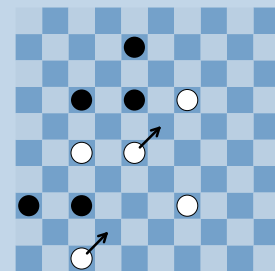
How Jannes learned to play draughts

Jannes van der Wal used to lose all games to his older brother Harke. Until he learned a new game from one of his neighbors: draughts. Later he wrote about that first draughts game: "I remember that in the end, we both had a king, and that my king was captured off the board." But Jannes had finally found 'his' game. His dad, who knew how to play draughts, gave him some good advice, but Jannes learned most of it himself. He read draughts books from the public library bus that once every week went by his village. And he solved the draughts puzzles in the newspaper.

Jannes also loved to make draughts puzzles himself. Here's one he made when he was 14 years old. If you manage to play the first two moves in the right order, you'll get a king. Then the black king has to make a capture and the white king can capture two pieces. Did you spot the correct landing space for the white king?!

When he was aged 12, Jannes joined a draughts club. If people asked him what he aspired in draughts, he always told them "becoming world champion". People laughed about that. But Jannes proved them wrong: in 1982 he completed his quest in Brazil!

DIAGRAM 22



Game of the week: showing a cool shot

A lot of people love to make shots. Giving away a few pieces and then capturing a lot of your opponent's pieces... that's great! And you know what? You get to promote draughts with a really beautiful combination. Play along with the solutions, and you'll see how cool they are. The numbers in the diagram signal the order of the moves. You can show the shot you like best to everyone who wants to see it. But of course, first make sure you know the combination by heart.

DIAGRAM 23

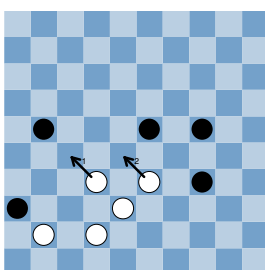


DIAGRAM 24

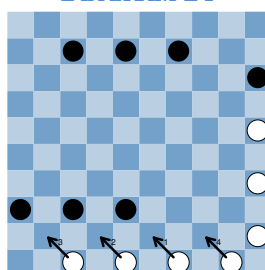
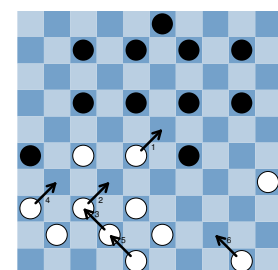


DIAGRAM 25



Lesson 12

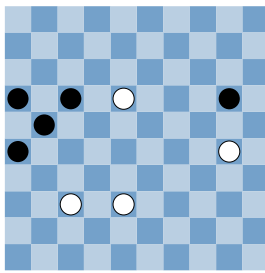
Good game!

We're at the end of this twelve lesson draughts course. For you, this might be the start of a brand-new hobby. This last lesson repeats the most important plans in draughts. You'll receive a few positions to analyze by yourself. But of course, the most fun part of draughts is to play the game. For example, in a school's draughts team, or at a draughts club. Draughts become a real sport then. In which, of course, you should show some good sportsmanship.

Good game!

Playing with a plan

DIAGRAM 1



In DIAGRAM 1 a very exciting game is going on. Matt of Lincoln School plays Isabella of Oak Grove School. Isabella plays black, and has already been taught eleven lessons in draughts by her teacher. If you listen closely, you can hear her thinking:

"I'm one piece behind... but black didn't develop his pieces quite well. Let's see... what shall I play... which plans are there again? Getting to king... attacking... blocking... and what's black planning on? Can he attack... go to king... Hey, he threatens to make a shot! If black want to attack me, I move forwards and he's completely blocked... Now let's make sure he can't play on the left side... Then I'll have to wait with getting to king... and instead play that move: yes, that's the way to block all black pieces!"

Can you mark the move that Isabella played with an arrow? Moments later she won her game and earned two points for her team. And a pat on the back of her teacher, who had said for the umpteenth time:

👉 *Pay attention... and play with a plan*

 Exercise 1 All plans, mixed up

In the following nine positions, you play white against black players of different strengths. Use your board to find out white's best move.

Sometimes you can easily win in one move, sometimes you'll need a few moves, but there are also positions in which you should be very careful. Did you try all moves? Great, then use arrows to mark the best move.

DIAGRAM 2

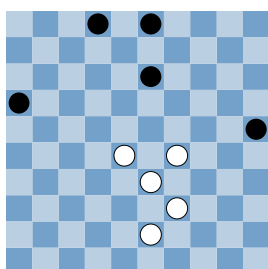


DIAGRAM 3

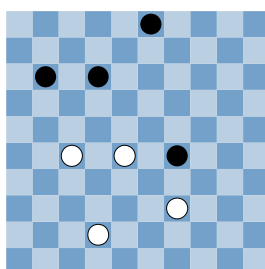


DIAGRAM 4

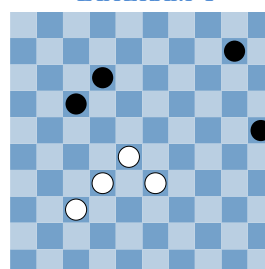


DIAGRAM 5

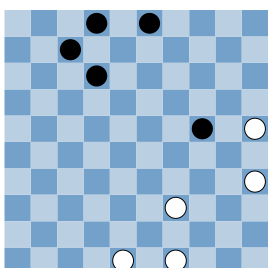


DIAGRAM 6

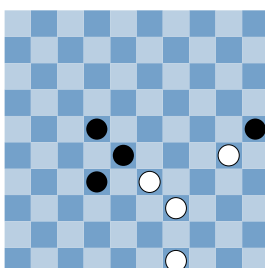


DIAGRAM 7

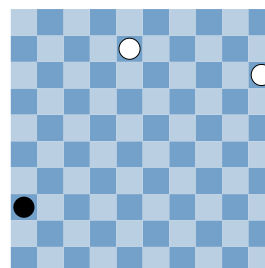


DIAGRAM 8

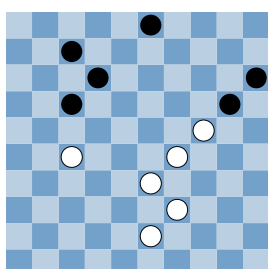


DIAGRAM 9

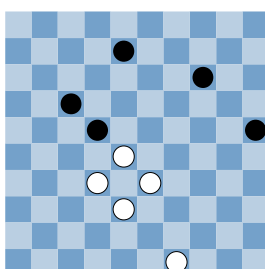
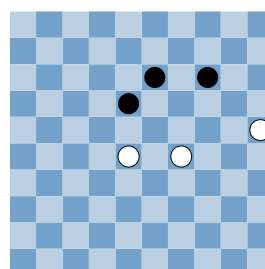


DIAGRAM 10



Playing draughts in a team

Draughts is first and foremost an individual sport. But you can also play the game as a team. A lot of kids get to know the game exactly in that way: they participate in a team of their school in the school draughts tournament.

A team match usually is played according to the following rules:

- ☒ Before the match, each team creates a line-up, which states which player plays which board.
- ☒ The team that plays a home match, plays with white at the odd boards (1, 3, 5, and so on)
- ☒ The individual results are added up to team total. The team with the most points wins the game.



Exercise 2

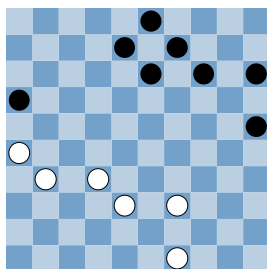
We go back to the game between Oak Grove and Lincoln. This is the line-up of both teams:

board 1	Isabella - Matt	
board 2	James - Emily	0 - 2
board 3	Lily - Charlotte	0 - 2
board 4	David - Joshua	

Will you enter the result on board 1?

At board 4 (DIAGRAM 11), Joshua just offered a draw. Should David accept the offer, or should he continue playing? David will accept/reject the draw offer, because.....

DIAGRAM 11



The Harlem shot

Already in the beginning of a game, black is able to prepare a combination: the Harlem shot. We've pictured it in three parts.

DIAGRAM 12: White begins and black attacks this piece.

DIAGRAM 13: White closes the gap like this... a grave mistake! This is where the Harlem shot starts. The black moves are marked in the correct order.

DIAGRAM 14: This is the resulting position after the shot. Black will capture another piece on the next move and will then be two pieces ahead!

DIAGRAM 12

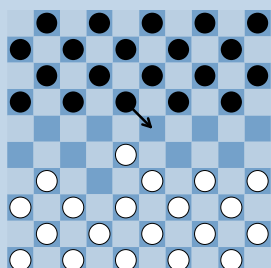


DIAGRAM 13

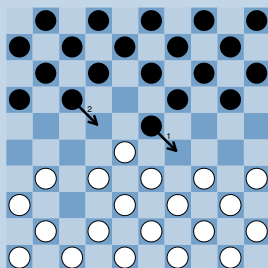
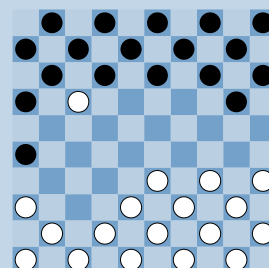


DIAGRAM 14



Sport and sportsmanship

Draughts is a sport. Who plays draughts, should show sportsmanship. Do you know to do that? Discuss this with your fellow students or teacher, and try to come up with three examples of sportsmanlike behavior. Can you also think of examples of foul play in draughts?

Sportsmanlike behavior:

1.
2.
3.

Foul play:

1.
2.
3.



Exercise 3

Play a game the way it's supposed to be!

- ✓ According to all rules
- ✓ Think first, then move
- ✓ Show sportsmanship

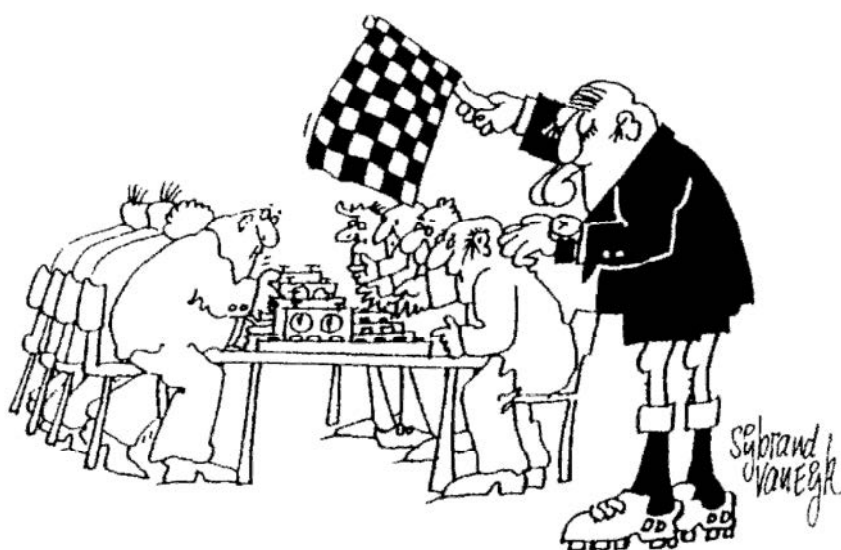
Good game!

Game of the week: the team competition

At the end of this draughts course we'll play a team competition. Two or more teams will play each other. You'll find how much fun that is. There are a lot of ways to create teams. All pupils who did this course could play against each other. Or you challenge the teachers at your school. But you can also create teams at home, for example, play against the neighbors. Or make up teams of one street against another.

It doesn't really matter how many teams join the competition, but try to make sure that:

- √ All teams should have an equal number of team members (2, 3, 4... or even 10 players)
- √ There should be enough boards and pieces.
- √ There should be a referee, or someone who keeps track of the score.
- √ Each team should make a line-up in advance (like we did in exercise 2).
- √ And then: let's play draughts!



Lesson 1

DIAGRAM 3

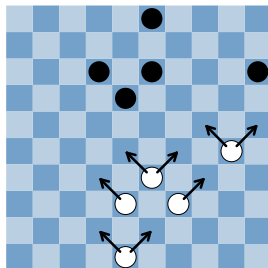


DIAGRAM 8

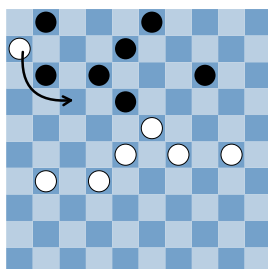


DIAGRAM 10

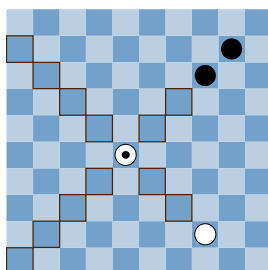


DIAGRAM 11

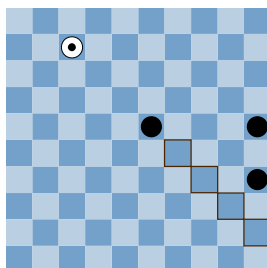
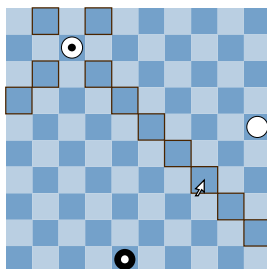


DIAGRAM 12



Exercise 1

Here's diagram 3 again. Each possible white move is marked with an arrow. In total, white has eight possible moves.

When white made his move, black has seven possible moves.

In the initial position, both white and black have nine possible moves.

Exercise 2

Diagram 6

White makes the capture with his piece on the right edge of the board.

Diagram 7

Did you find a capture? No? Well done! There's no capturing possibility for white in this position, however, there is one for black.

Diagram 8

White can capture a black piece backwards, see the diagram.

Exercise 3

Diagram 10

White can make twelve moves with his king. Which move would be really silly?

Diagram 11

The king has to jump over the piece. He has four fields to land on.

You'll surely see which field he'd better not stop...

Diagram 12

The king now even has 13 fields to end its move. All moves are OK, but one move is absolutely the best one. We placed a cursor on that field.

Do you see what happens?

Exercise 4

Diagram 14

Both players have a king. It's completely equal. No king is in danger: it's a draw.

Diagram 15

Black wins. The three white pieces will all be captured.

Diagram 16

Black wins, because white has no moves left. He's completely blocked!

Lesson 2

Exercise 1

Here are the three diagrams again. Each capture is indicated with an arrow.

DIAGRAM 1

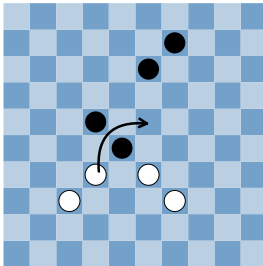


DIAGRAM 2

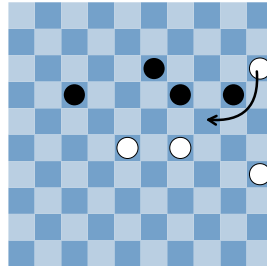


DIAGRAM 3

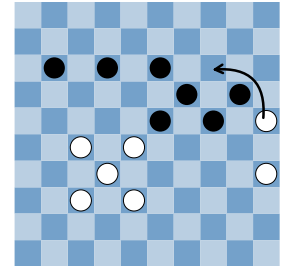


DIAGRAM 7

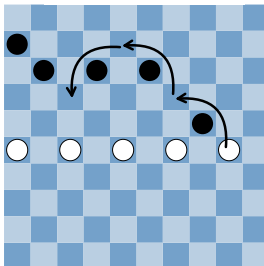


DIAGRAM 9

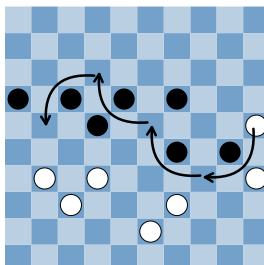
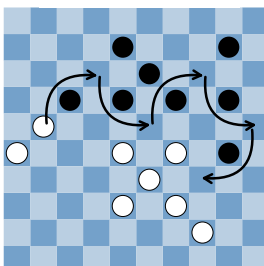


DIAGRAM 10



Exercise 2

Diagram 5

White captures two pieces. Did you see that?

Diagram 6

Don't capture to king; you should capture two pieces, backwards!

Diagram 7

Watch the majority rule. Don't capture rightwards, but catch three pieces leftwards. The capture is displayed here.

Diagram 8

The white player first makes a turn, returns to its initial position, and then captures the remaining two black pieces. So he captures six pieces in total! And... the white piece does *not become a king*, even though he reached the other side. He has to continue his capture as a piece.

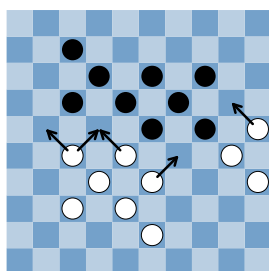
Diagram 9

White has a lot of capturing possibilities. But the majority capture has priority: four pieces will be captured. Did you notice that in return, black catches three pieces and gets a king?

Diagram 10

White would love to capture to the king's row. But the majority capture of five pieces has priority. Probably white will be satisfied nonetheless...

DIAGRAM 13



Exercise 3

We found five moves that won't end well for white. Try them yourself on your board. If you found three of these, you really did a good job!

Exercise 4

Diagram 14

White captures two pieces. Black also takes two... and wins!

Diagram 15

White captures three pieces. But black takes five!

Diagram 16

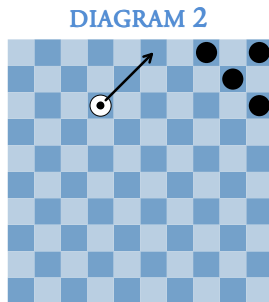
White captures three pieces. Black takes four... and wins!



Lesson 3

Exercise 1

Diagram 2



That's a great move by white! In this way, he blocks all black pieces. Each piece that tries to cross the diagonal, will be captured by the white king.

Diagram 3

Lots of novices would love to get a strong king. That's not really a wrong line of thought, but there's a much better move here: white can capture four pieces with his king, which will end the game immediately: white wins!

Diagram 4

White captures two pieces, but after that, black takes the white king off the board...

Exercise 2

Here you'll find the six diagrams of this exercise again. Did you manage to mark the correct moves? You've deserved a pat on the back then!

DIAGRAM 5

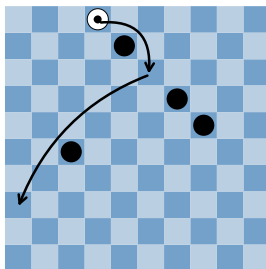


DIAGRAM 6

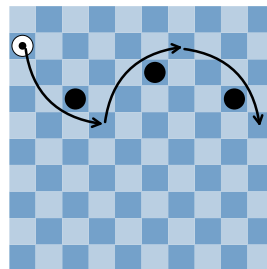


DIAGRAM 7

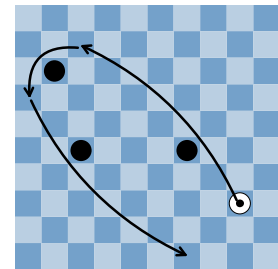


DIAGRAM 8

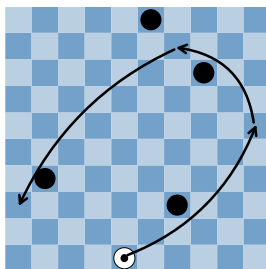


DIAGRAM 9

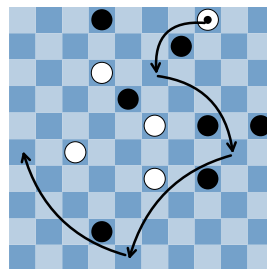


DIAGRAM 10

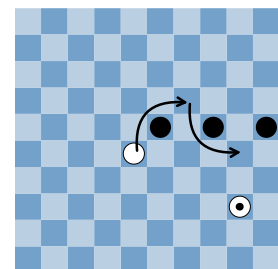
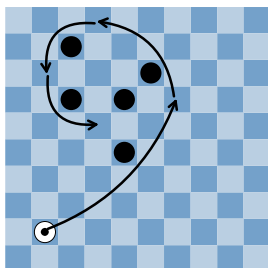


DIAGRAM 12



Exercise 3

Diagram 12

Black wins! White can only take four black pieces here. And black's last piece will then capture the white king.

Diagram 13

No, because then he has to capture to and fro, and that's not allowed. White will have to capture either the king or the piece. Did you also spot the strong move black is able to play afterwards? He will move his king to the corner or get a king in the other corner, and black will win the game!

Diagram 14

No, that's not allowed. You should ask your opponent to withdraw his move and point out the correct capture. As you know, the rules of play state: "capturing is compulsory".

Exercise 4

The diagrams are printed here again, and the correct capture is marked.

DIAGRAM 15

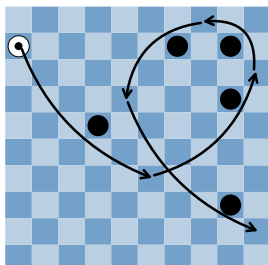


DIAGRAM 16

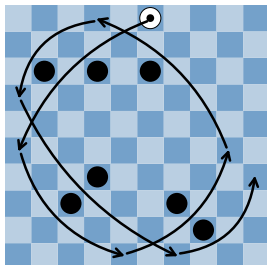
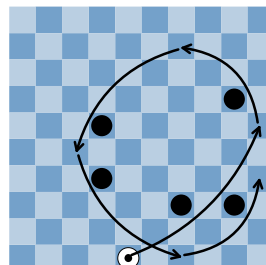
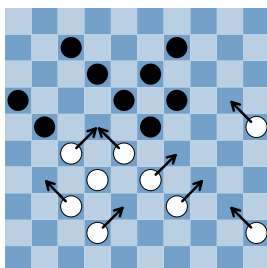


DIAGRAM 17



Lesson 4

DIAGRAM 2



Exercise 1

Diagram 2

White has eight different moves to choose from.

Exercise 2

- ♣ *Always check whether you can make a capture* (page 1.7).
- ♣ *Watch your pieces... don't let them just get captured* (1.9).
- ♣ *Use your king, it's a strong piece!* (1.11).

Exercise 3

Diagram 4

A strong move! Black will have to give away his last piece.

Diagram 5

White can just capture two pieces.

Diagram 6

Quickly move between the two black pieces with your front right piece.

White will then capture a piece... or get a nice king.

DIAGRAM 4

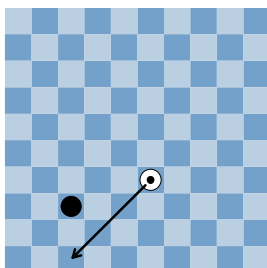


DIAGRAM 7

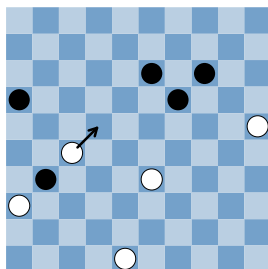


Diagram 7

Did you spot black threatening to capture? Let's move that piece forward!

DIAGRAM 8

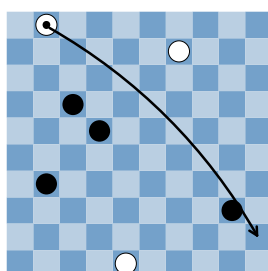


Diagram 8

Sometimes, the king travels a long distance before capturing a piece.

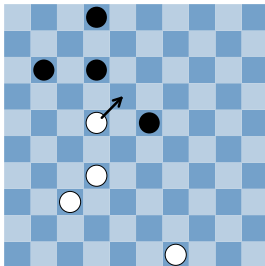
Diagram 9

If you've paid attention, you will surely have found that white can take a piece.



Lesson 5

DIAGRAM 2



Exercise 1

Diagram 2

White moves his piece between the black pieces: double trouble!

Diagram 3

White can attack the foremost black piece in two ways. Leftwards is OK, he will win the piece. Rightwards is not going to suffice: black will defend his piece by closing the gap.

DIAGRAM 3

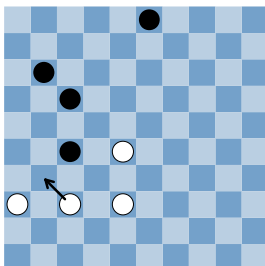
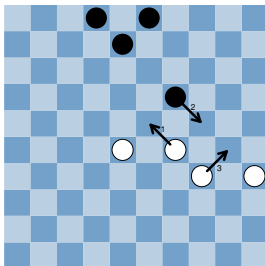


Diagram 4

Black is able to evade the first attack, but after that, white attacks another time, and will win a piece!

DIAGRAM 4



Exercise 2

Diagram 6

A white piece is being attacked. White can defend by closing the gap in his defenses.

Diagram 7

Did you spot the attack? Then you've surely found the best move for white: just walk away with that piece!

Diagram 8

White is able to defend himself with an exchange: he gives away a piece and takes one in return. With an exchange the position stays equal.

DIAGRAM 6

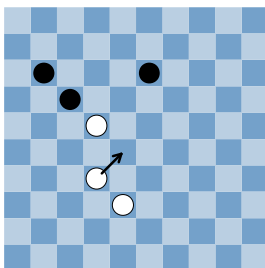


DIAGRAM 7

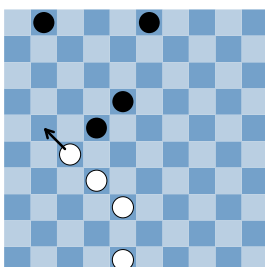


DIAGRAM 8

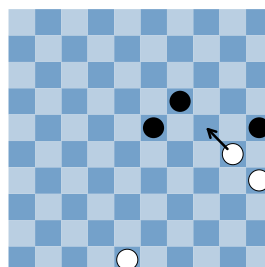


Diagram 10

Did you spot the threat? With the move that's marked in the diagram, white makes sure he takes one piece in return.

Another attack. White has two defenses: walking away or closing the gap. Which move would you play?

A 10x10 grid world environment. The grid is composed of alternating light blue and dark blue squares. A white circle with a black outline, representing a robot, is located at the bottom-left corner (row 10, column 1). An arrow points from the robot towards the top-right. There are several black circles representing obstacles: one at (row 1, column 1), one at (row 2, column 3), one at (row 3, column 5), one at (row 4, column 7), one at (row 5, column 9), one at (row 6, column 3), and one at (row 7, column 5). There are also several white circles with black outlines: one at (row 1, column 1), one at (row 2, column 1), one at (row 3, column 1), one at (row 4, column 1), one at (row 5, column 1), one at (row 6, column 1), one at (row 7, column 1), one at (row 8, column 1), one at (row 9, column 1), and one at (row 10, column 1).

This time, there's no threat. So there's an opportunity for white to attack. Using his leftmost piece he moves in between the black pieces... and will win a piece! On the other side of the board, white can attack as well, but did you notice black can then defend with an exchange?

A 10x10 grid world environment. The grid is composed of light blue and white squares in a checkerboard pattern. A robot, represented by a white circle with a black outline and a black arrow pointing towards the top-right, is located at the bottom center (row 9, column 5). A goal, represented by a white circle with a black outline, is located at the bottom left (row 9, column 1). Three obstacles, represented by solid black circles, are located at (row, column) coordinates (2, 3), (2, 8), and (3, 7). The grid is bounded by a thick black line.

White has to take care. His foremost piece quickly needs help, otherwise black will simple devour it. With the marked move, white will just be in time to save his piece. You're quite clever if you found that.

In this position, there is more than one way to attack, but only with this move white will actually win a piece.

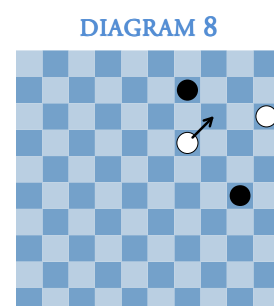
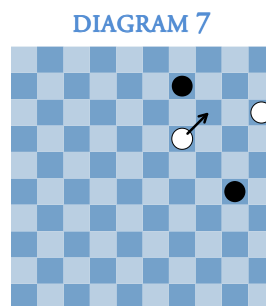
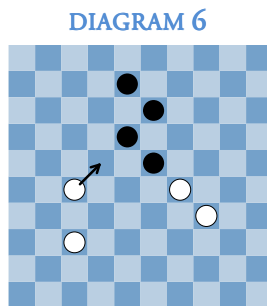
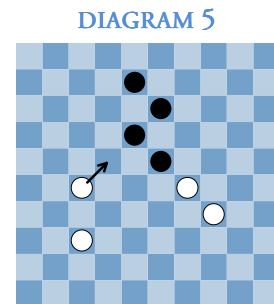
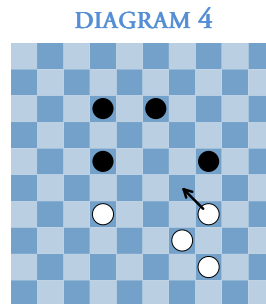
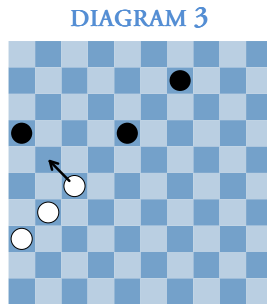
A 10x10 checkerboard with alternating blue and white squares. There are five black dots and two white dots. An arrow points from the white dot at (1, 9) to the black dot at (4, 4).

A king can also be used for attacking. And quite well, that is! After this smart move, black will lose one piece at the minimum. You should try whether white can win the game as well.

Lesson 6

Exercise 1

Here's the six diagrams again, with the best move marked with an arrow.



Exercise 2

Diagram 11

Black threatens to give a piece and take two pieces in return. White can prevent that by moving his left foremost piece.

Diagram 12

Black threatens to take out the middle piece of the three white pieces in a row. White has two ways of preventing that from happening. He can use both his left foremost piece (move it to the edge of the board), or his foremost central piece for that.

Diagram 13

Black threatens to sacrifice his foremost piece... and capture three pieces in return. What can white do against that? His right foremost piece... but then black is able to attack that piece and conquer it... did you see that? He had better put his left bottom piece into play. That will successfully eliminate the shot possibility!

DIAGRAM 15

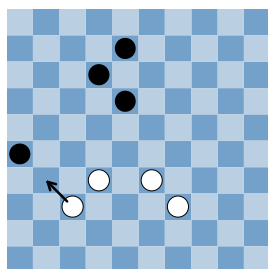


DIAGRAM 16

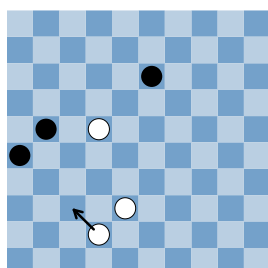


DIAGRAM 17

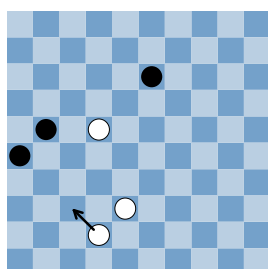
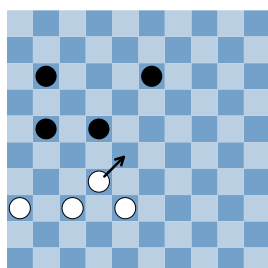


DIAGRAM 18



Exercise 3

We've marked the best move with an arrow.

Diagram 15

Give two, take three in return. That's some profit!

Diagram 16

Black threatened with a small shot.

Diagram 17

Let's quickly close up the hole: again, there was a shot threatening.

Diagram 18

Give three and take three... and getting a nice king on the next move!

Diagram 19

A smart move allows white to destroy the whole black position. Not very hard... but not that easy to find though!

Diagram 20

White can give two pieces, and will take three in return. Check for yourself whether the resulting position is winning!

DIAGRAM 19

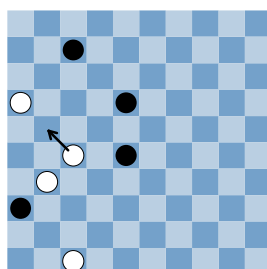
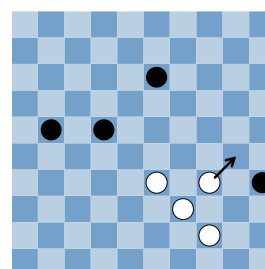


DIAGRAM 20



Lesson 7

Exercise 1

If white makes the good move, he will win this game. If you read the paragraph on blocking, you'll learn how that works.

Exercise 2

Diagram 3

The right piece to the left... and black is blocked! He is able to give away a piece and try his luck with his last piece, but that one will be blocked as well.

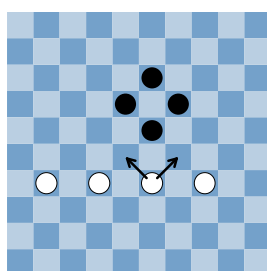
Diagram 4

White cleverly moves to the right edge of the board. And with only two pieces he manages to block all three black pieces.

Diagram 5

There are two ways to win here. Both are displayed in the diagram.

DIAGRAM 5



Exercise 3

Diagram 8

White has exactly one good move left: he has to move his bottommost piece!

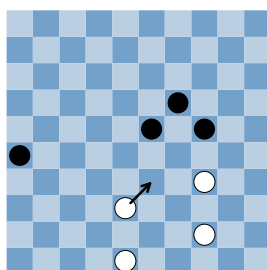
Diagram 9

The white piece has to go left! If he doesn't, he will be blocked; now he will be able to escape to a draw.

Diagram 10

Watch out! If white moves to the edge, he will be blocked. Did you spot that? That's why an exchange is the best option here: give one piece, and take one in return.

DIAGRAM 11



Exercise 4

You'll find the six diagrams here again. The best move has been marked in the diagram.

Diagram 11

This will block the black group. And the left piece can just be stopped!

Diagram 12

Beware! The other two moves are not correct. Do you see why?

Diagram 13

Giving two and taking two! And after this nifty exchange, black is blocked..

Diagram 14

After this move, the black formation can't move a bit: blocked!

Diagram 15

If white plays the other move (to the edge), he will be blocked. Did you notice that?

Diagram 16

White will make two moves with his bottom right piece (can also go the other way)... and black will be blocked. Who found this... deserves a nice treat!

DIAGRAM 12

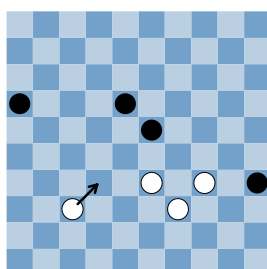


DIAGRAM 13

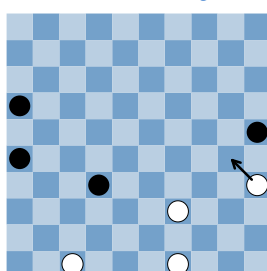


DIAGRAM 14

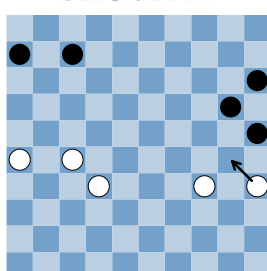


DIAGRAM 15

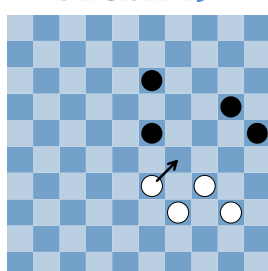
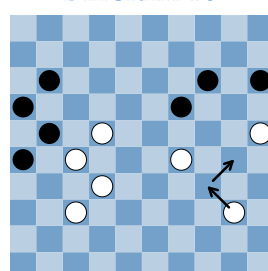


DIAGRAM 16



Lesson 8

Exercise 1

Diagram 2

White will move his foremost piece between black's... and will get a king quickly!

Diagram 3

The foremost right piece is clearly closest to king. But black is able to hold back that piece. White had better move his left piece. Then the path to king is clear!

Diagram 4

A king is well worth a piece. So white sacrifice his piece on the left edge of the board... and proceeds to king with his foremost piece.

DIAGRAM 4

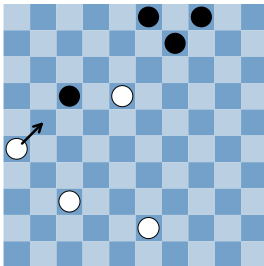


DIAGRAM 9

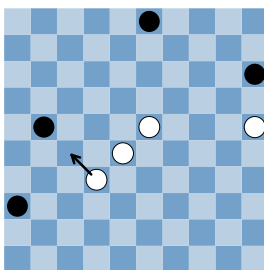


DIAGRAM 10

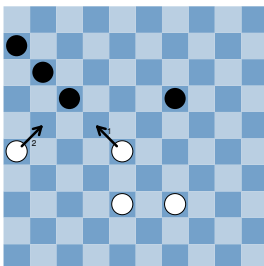
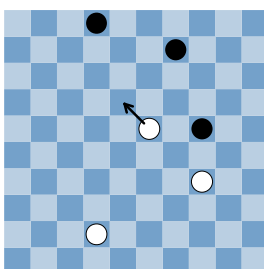


DIAGRAM 12



Exercise 2

Diagram 7

The black piece on the left almost reached king's row. But white can just hold it back with his bottommost piece!

Diagram 8

Black threatens to sacrifice a piece to get a king. But white is able to prevent that. He moves his bottommost piece rightwards!

Diagram 9

Again, danger on the left side of the board. An exchange will fill up the hole in white's defenses.

Exercise 3

Diagram 10

Black threatens with a shot! White can use one of his bottom pieces to close the gap. Did you see that white can also make a strong sacrifice? He can give away a piece and blocks two pieces afterwards!

Diagram 11

With his center piece, white moves rightwards... and black is blocked!

Diagram 12

Look out for that attack. So play your foremost piece.

DIAGRAM 14

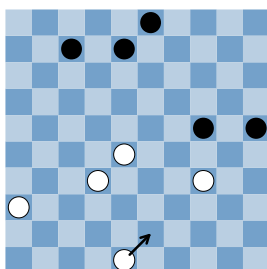


DIAGRAM 17

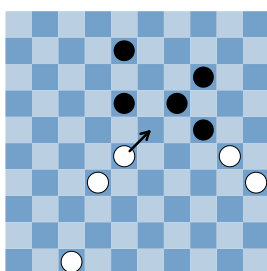


DIAGRAM 18

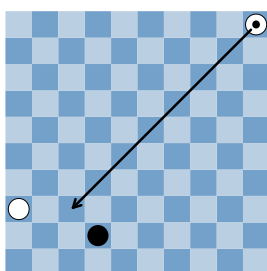


Diagram 13

A strong exchange paves the path to king for white. Of course, you should try whether white can actually win the game then!

Diagram 14

Black threatens to attack on the right side of the board to get to a king. White can prevent that with his bottommost piece.

Diagram 15

White has to make the capture! Did you also notice how the game will continue? Yes, that's correct: he will give another two piece and will capture five pieces at once!

Diagram 16

After the first attack, black is able to defend himself. But then white launches another attack... this time winning the game!

Diagram 17

White uses the majority rule neatly... and breaks through to king!

Diagram 18

This seems to end in a draw. But white will still win... by giving away his king! Quite the surprise, right?



Lesson 9

DIAGRAM 3

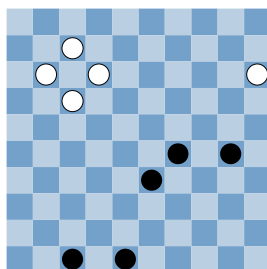


DIAGRAM 4

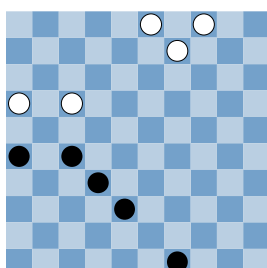
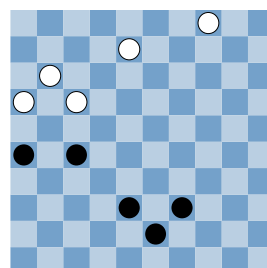


DIAGRAM 5



Exercise 2

These are our solutions. But there are other solutions possible! As long as you found the weak spot that we have indicated in the answers below.

Diagram 3

The white defense on the right side is quite weak: there's only one piece there. You're able to make an exchange with that piece, and then get to a strong king!

Diagram 4

Who put up his pieces like this, will be able to make a nice shot on the next move! Actually, there's even another way. When you solved this one, that's quite a feat!

Diagram 5

You should be able to block the three-piece formation! That will need two pieces at the least. The other three pieces you can use to try and beat the two loose pieces.

Exercise 3

3a

An advantage is that your opponent won't be able to get a king that easily. And those pieces are safe for capturing, as they're on the edge of the board.

A disadvantage is that your other pieces will be in danger more easily, like in this example! Actually, when all of your other pieces have been blocked or taken, you'll have to play your bottommost pieces. And then it will take a very long time to ever get a king yourself!

3b

✓ Play quickly: most kids play very quickly. They don't really seem to be interested in the game, maybe they're more interested in the result?

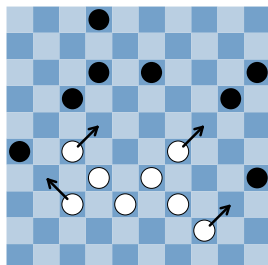
✓ Forgetting to capture: of course that's also because of the rapid playing style, and consequently not paying attention to every move that's being played.

✓ Giving away pieces carelessly: this happens a lot, especially when you play quickly and don't pay enough attention!

Ton Sijbrands

After the attack in diagram 6, black gives away his foremost piece and captures the attacking piece: a winning exchange!

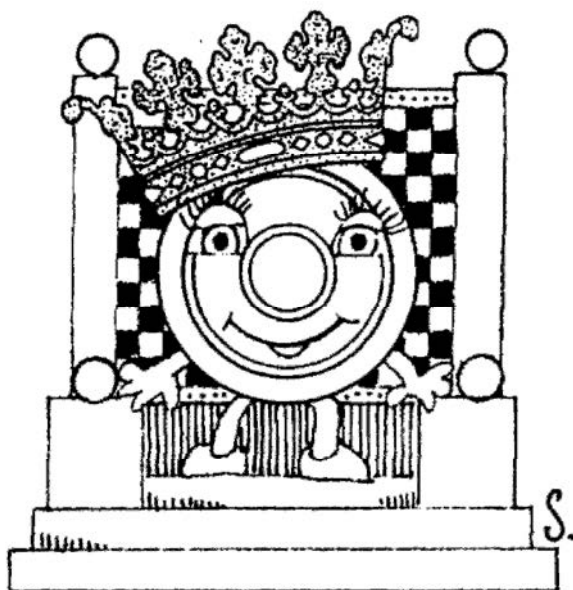
DIAGRAM 8



Exercise 4

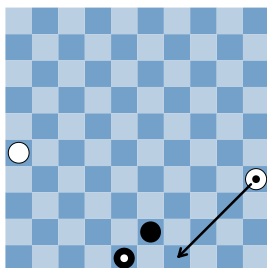
4a

In diagram 8, white has nine moves. This includes four exchanges (look at the arrow). Did you spot them all? Actually, white has five different exchanges: after the exchange in the left front of the board, white can make the capture in two different ways!



Lesson 10

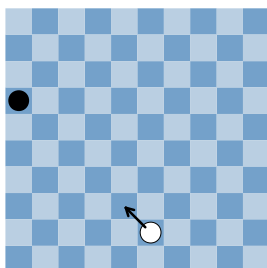
DIAGRAM 1



Exercise 1

A beautiful attack using the white king. Black will have to play with his king... and will be captured!

DIAGRAM 3



Exercise 2

Diagram 3

Now white does create contact with the black piece. Moving to the left is thus the right choice, and black will be blocked.

DIAGRAM 4

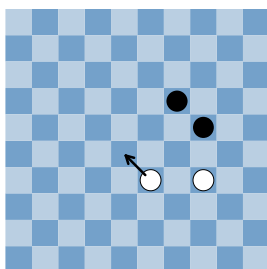


Diagram 4

Move the left piece to the left... and the lock is completed! Even if black sacrifices a piece now, we won't break white's defenses. With only two pieces all black pieces are kept in check.

In the starting position, attacking twice will win a piece... but then black can get to king. Therefore that's not the right solution.

DIAGRAM 5

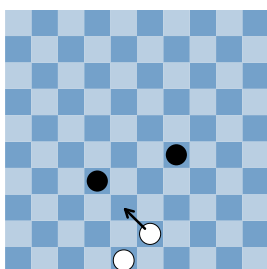


Diagram 5

White exchanges and wins! If he doesn't, black can actually win the game, did you spot how?

DIAGRAM 6

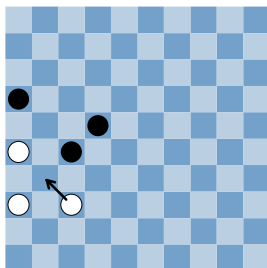


Diagram 6

The attack seems to be sufficient. But black can continue with a spectacular sacrifice then. He gives two (in the correct way!)... takes a piece in return... gets a king... and it will be a draw!

White can win however, with a really calm move on the edge. If black then tries to move along, white will secure the win with a small shot!

DIAGRAM 7

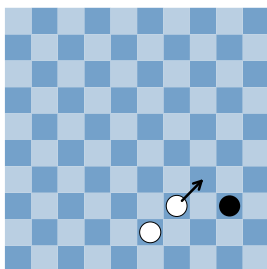


Diagram 7

White's one piece ahead. He can use this advantage for a pretty sacrifice! And he will use his last piece to block the black one.

DIAGRAM 8

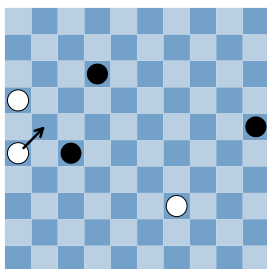
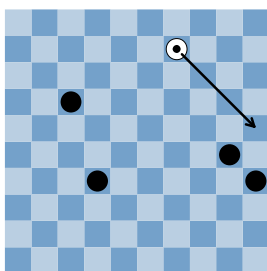


Diagram 8

Don't go to king too soon. There's a better move available here: attack the black piece, and if black walks away, you're able to make a combination: backwards this time!

DIAGRAM 9



Exercise 3

Diagram 9

This attack looks like the one in DIAGRAM 1. Whatever move black makes, white will take a least three pieces in return.

DIAGRAM 10

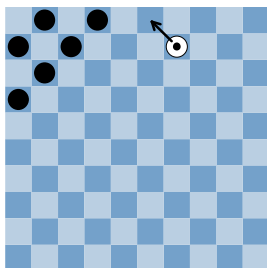


Diagram 10

Check that king blocking those six black pieces! They're completely stuck: every piece that tries to cross the diagonal will be captured.

DIAGRAM 11

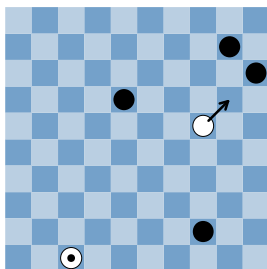


Diagram 11

Did you spot the cool combination? White gives away a piece and takes all of black's pieces!

DIAGRAM 12

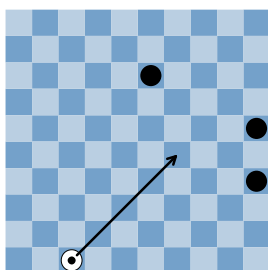


Diagram 12

The king moves four squares to the right... now the black pieces won't be able to continue without being captured.

DIAGRAM 13

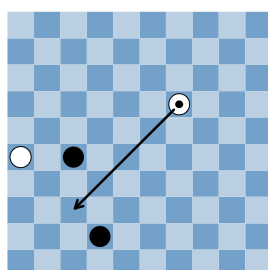


Diagram 13

The foremost black piece can just be stopped. White makes a surprising move: he sacrifices his king.

DIAGRAM 14

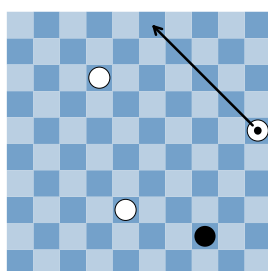
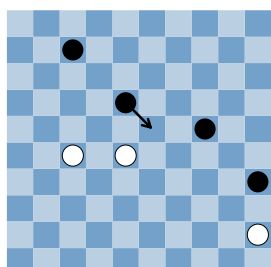


Diagram 14

The black piece will get to king. But white makes a witty trap with this move. The black king will always be captured. Did you spot this one? Well done!.

DIAGRAM 15



Karen van Lith

After Karen's beautiful move in DIAGRAM 15, both players have two pieces left. But whichever move white makes in this endgame, she will always be completely blocked.

Lesson 11

Exercise 1

DIAGRAM 1, 2 en 3 are direct shots. White gives a piece and takes three in return. Got that?

In DIAGRAM 4 you need to be careful. Black threatens making a shot on the right side of the board, there's only one way to defend. And in DIAGRAM 6 white will give away one piece... then another... and will take four himself!

DIAGRAM 1

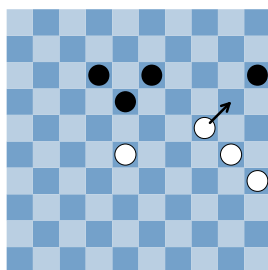


DIAGRAM 2

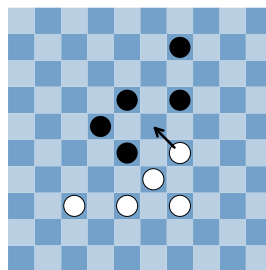


DIAGRAM 3

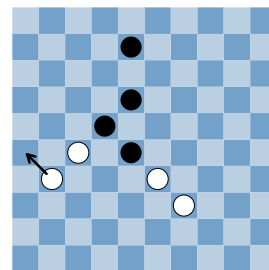


DIAGRAM 4

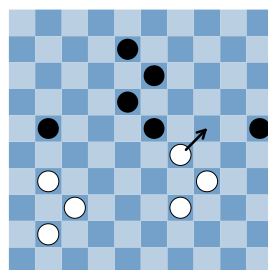


DIAGRAM 5

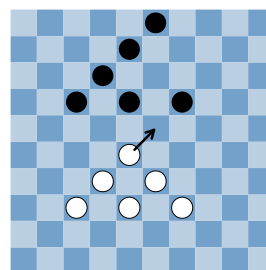
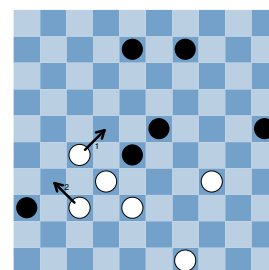


DIAGRAM 6



Exercise 2

White will give away four (D8), two (D9), three (D10), two (D11), three (D12) pieces in succession... and will take a lot of pieces in return. In DIAGRAM 13, let's first give away a piece on the right... black will capture... give another three... and the remainder goes without saying!

DIAGRAM 8

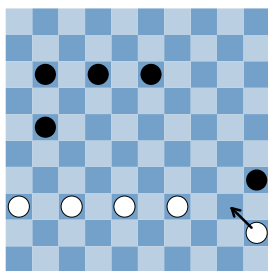


DIAGRAM 9

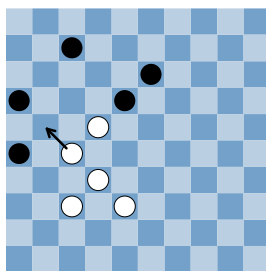


DIAGRAM 10

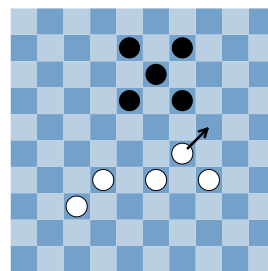


DIAGRAM 11

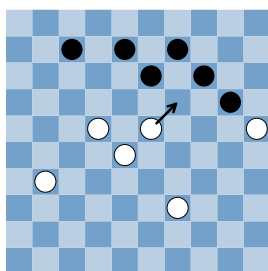


DIAGRAM 12

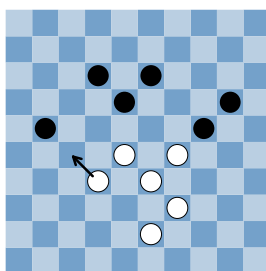
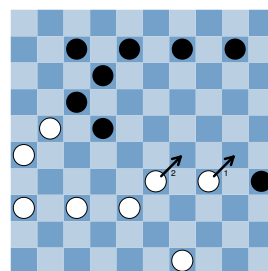


DIAGRAM 13



Exercise 3

Here you'll see the winning moves. If you found most, you're really good at making shots!

DIAGRAM 15

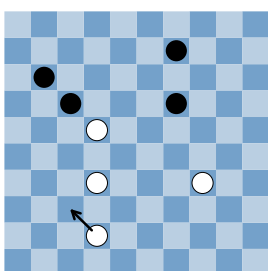


DIAGRAM 16

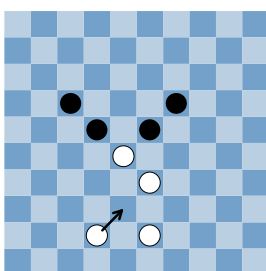


DIAGRAM 17

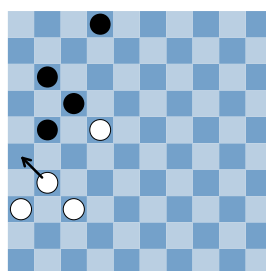


DIAGRAM 18

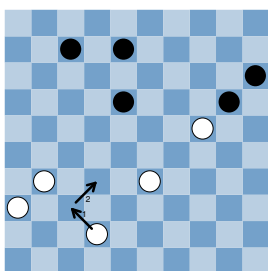


DIAGRAM 19

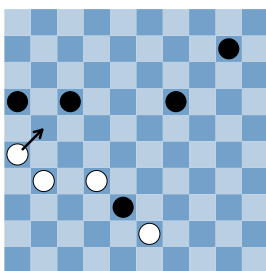
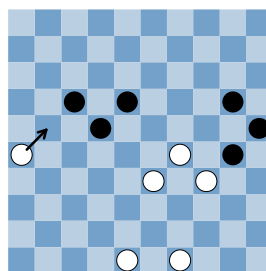


DIAGRAM 20



Then there's this...

Taking shots is massive fun... and really convenient to help winning a game. If you really want to train your skills, you should try the exercise books at the end of this course book. You'll find some clever advice for playing draughts and... hundreds of shots!

DIAGRAM 2

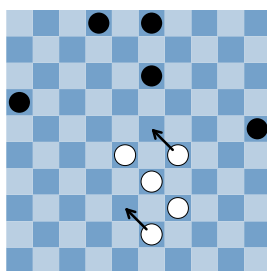


DIAGRAM 3

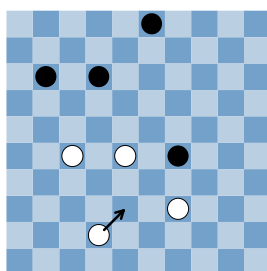


DIAGRAM 4

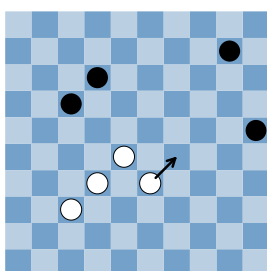


DIAGRAM 5

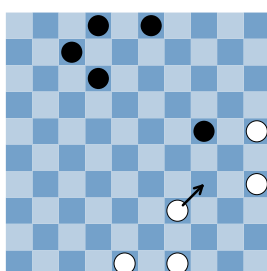
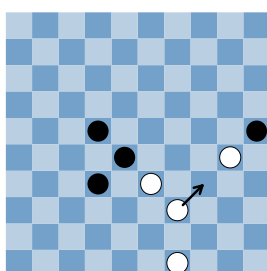


DIAGRAM 6



Lesson 12

Exercise 1

Diagram 2

Watch the black piece on the left. That one wants to go to king. There's two moves to stop him. Can you foretell how the game will continue if black still tries to get a king?

Diagram 3

Black threatened with an attack! This is the best defense. Do you see why?

Diagram 4

Black threatens to break through on the right side of the board. But white will be right on time when he plays this move. If black still moves on, white can perform a nice shot!

Diagram 5

White will attack black's foremost piece... and will get a king afterwards!

Diagram 6

Don't go to king... because black will do that as well then. White can win however, with a beautiful shot! Did you spot that one? Wow, that's cool!

DIAGRAM 7

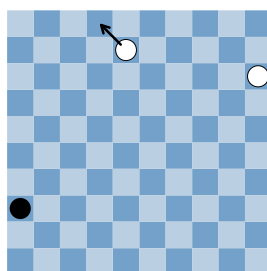


Diagram 7

On the next move, white puts his king on the central diagonal and he will attack the black piece. Whatever move black will react with, white is then always able to win.

DIAGRAM 8

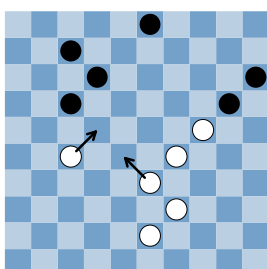


Diagram 8

Watch for the combination! There are two moves to prevent the shot: an exchange and a normal move.

Diagram 9

Did you spot the danger? Black threatens to block white. So white had better move forward quickly

DIAGRAM 9

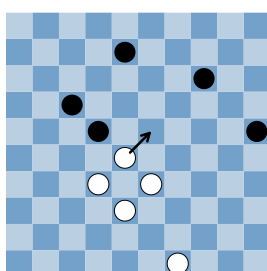


Diagram 10

A brilliant move. Black will have to attack now. And then white is able to win by giving away two pieces and taking two back in return. Who was able to find this move, should join really join the local draughts club!

Exercise 2

David's team is currently behind: 2-4. If he accepts the draw offer, they'll lose 3-5. He had better play along, even though he's two pieces behind. Try whether you are able to win the white position!

DIAGRAM 10

